

Physical Education

Year 4

Student Manual



Physical Education

Year 4 · Student Book

Adapted is not a lesser version. It is the same lesson.

INSIDE THIS BOOK

- Four families: run, jump, throw and cross
- Distances, heights and timings all adjustable
- The rule of the game, printed on every topic
- A decision to make, with no answer printed
- Stay safe panels, written to the pupil

IMPRINT

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Physical Education · Year 4

Student Manual. First edition, 2026.

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Safety, and it is not a formality. This is a Physical Education book, so almost every task moves a body through a space, and this year several bodies move through it at once. Every task assumes a teacher present, a space checked before the lesson, and apparatus set out and tested by an adult. The teacher carries out their own risk assessment and follows the school's safety policy. Where a task carries a particular risk, the book says so on the page in a green **Stay safe** panel. Those panels are instructions, not advice.

Inclusion. Every comparison in this book asks a pupil to look at their own earlier attempt. No task ranks one pupil against another, and no task requires a particular body to succeed. Teachers adapt distances, heights and timings freely: the objective is control, not size.

British English throughout. Printed in Portugal on paper from responsibly managed forests.

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Your sports year

Three terms, and at the end of each one the whole year group comes out onto the field for a day. You already know what is coming, so you can practise for it.

TERM 1	TERM 2	TERM 3
December	March	June
Athletics Day ● Sprint ● Relays ● Standing long jump ● Target throw ● Obstacle race <i>Unit 1 is the one that gets you ready: a relay is four movers and three joins.</i>	Football Day ● Dribbling in and out of the cones ● Passing accuracy game ● Penalty shootout ● Full game <i>A full game is topic 1.4 for ninety minutes: everybody moving at once.</i>	Multi-sports Day ● Bowling ● Sack racing ● Bean bag throw ● Water pong <i>Five different families of movement in one morning. That is your whole range, checked.</i>

Look down the three lists and count how many of those you practise in this book. The sprint, the relay, the standing long jump, the target throw and the obstacle race are **all** in Unit 1, and so is the thing that decides a football match: knowing where everybody else is going.

WHAT TO PRACTISE BEFORE EACH DAY

- 1 Before Athletics Day.** The round of eight in 1.1 has a throw, a jump, a travel and a stop in it. Those are four of the five events. For the relay, practise the three joins in 1.2 with a baton.
- 2 Before Football Day.** Topic 1.4 is the whole of it: read where somebody else is going, decide who gives way, and keep your movement when the ground changes.
- 3 Before Multi-sports Day.** Topic 1.1 again. A day of five different activities is a test of your **range**, not of any one skill.

Nothing on the three days is a surprise. That is the point of knowing the dates in August.

Welcome to the sports day field

Last year you learned the most useful thing in this whole subject: how to take one movement you could already do and make it better on purpose.

This year you are going to find out what happens when you have to do that with **everything at once**, on a field with other people on it.

Here is the difference, and it is a real one. On the Cinder Track in Year 3, one body moved at a time and two friends watched it. On the sports day field, four events run together. Somebody is throwing behind you. Somebody is coming down the next lane. The person who set out your station has just moved a cone while you were looking the other way.

None of that makes the movement harder. It makes **keeping** the movement harder, and that is the Year 4 job.



The six friends walk out. Rowan has the hoops, Bramble has the cones, Tuft has a clipboard almost as big as he is, Sorrel has the measuring tape and Pip has the baton. Willow is flying low behind them. Nobody is running yet, and everything in this book is being carried onto the field in this picture.

- 1 **The Grass Lanes.** Keeping the whole range of movements you have, linking more of them together, making them flow, and holding all of that when other people are on the grass.
- 2 **The Judges' Table.** Willow's place. The words a judge uses, and how to measure a performance against a criterion instead of a feeling.
- 3 **The Open Field.** Finding more than one answer to the same challenge, and moving to say something.
- 4 **The Team Enclosure.** Every job in a team, the goal you set yourself, and taking a turn at leading and at following.
- 5 **The Kit Marquee.** One marquee and a whole class: sharing, settling an argument without an adult, and what fair play costs.
- 6 **The Finish Field.** What is happening inside you while you move, how hard is hard enough, and what a moving body needs.

This book is part one. The other five follow.

Four jobs, and you will do all of them

Almost every task in this book needs four people, because you cannot watch yourself move, and because somebody has to change something while you work.

JOB	WHAT YOU DO	WHAT YOU MUST NOT DO
Mover	Do the movement, properly, as many times as the task says	Rush it to look quick, or change it halfway through
Timer	Count, or time, and say the number out loud	Guess, round the number kindly, or start the watch early
Watcher	Look at one thing only, and say what you saw	Say "good", which tells the mover nothing at all
Setter	Lay the ground out, and change one thing while the mover is working	Change something dangerous, or change it to catch somebody out

Swap jobs every time. The setter is the job people enjoy most, which is exactly why the rule above matters: a setter makes the task **realistic**, never impossible.

Meet the six

The same six as last year, a year older, and this year they share the field with the rest of the school.

Pip

Red squirrel, cream vest. Quick and willing, and first over the hurdle on the cover. This year he finds out that a movement he can do once is not yet a movement he owns.

Bramble

Badger, slate vest and shorts. Strong and steady, and he never rushes. He is the one in the class who can still do, in June, everything he could do in October.

Sorrel

Hare. The fastest of all of them, and this year that gets in her way. Fluent and fast are not the same thing, and giving up her one speed is the hardest work she does.

Tuft

Hedgehog. The smallest and the most careful. He reads the whole field before he moves into it, which makes him quietly the best in the class at the last topic in this unit.



Willow

Barn owl. She watches, from up on a post where she can see the whole shape of a movement and the whole field at the same time. She is the reason this book keeps asking you to say what you saw instead of saying whether you liked it.

When you see her notes in a slate-grey panel, that is Willow telling you exactly what one body did. Copy the way she says it, not just what she says.

Rowan

Otter. Happiest in a group, very good at giving everybody a job, and this year he is usually the setter. If a cone has moved, it was Rowan.

None of the six is better than the others. Each one is good at a different thing, which is exactly how a class works, and it is why the tasks keep making you swap.

How to use this book

Every part of the field is built the same way, so once you know the shapes you always know where you are.

SHAPE	WHAT IT MEANS
Come out to the field	A question to talk about before you move. There is no wrong answer yet.
What happened	The real problem for this topic. Everything after it is you sorting that out.
On this field you will	What you will be able to do by the end. Come back and check.
Warm up	Two minutes, straight in, and it is never optional in this subject.
Do you remember?	Something from an earlier year, or an earlier topic, that you are about to need again.
Learn	The marked field and the new idea. Read the drawing first, then the words.
Watch me try	One attempt, taken slowly, with the reason for each part.
Your turn	Your work. Move first, then write, draw and tick in the book.
Willow's own notes	What a watcher actually wrote down. A model for your own.
Stay safe	Green. An instruction, not a suggestion. Read it before you move.
The equipment you need	Fetch this before you start, so nobody stands about.
Did you know?	A true thing worth knowing that is not in any test.
Go a little further	For when you have finished and want more.
Field challenge	Harder. Expect to need three attempts.
The sports day	The project at the end of this part of the field.
How did it go?	You judging your own work, honestly.
Look what I can do	The tick list. Only tick what is true today.
Words we used	Every new word, with its meaning.

The marked fields

Wherever you see a green panel with painted white lines on it, you are looking at **the space seen from above**, the way Willow sees it. The marks always mean the same thing.

MARK	MEANS
a solid white line	a line you may not cross
a dashed white line	the route your body travels
a dotted line with an open arrow	the route somebody else travels
a white ring	where a body starts, or stops
a double ring	a place two bodies both want, at the same moment
a small cross	a cone, a marker or a flag
the ticks down the left edge	paces, counted

The last two rows of that table are new this year. In Year 3 nothing needed them, because only one body moved at a time.

Writing in this book

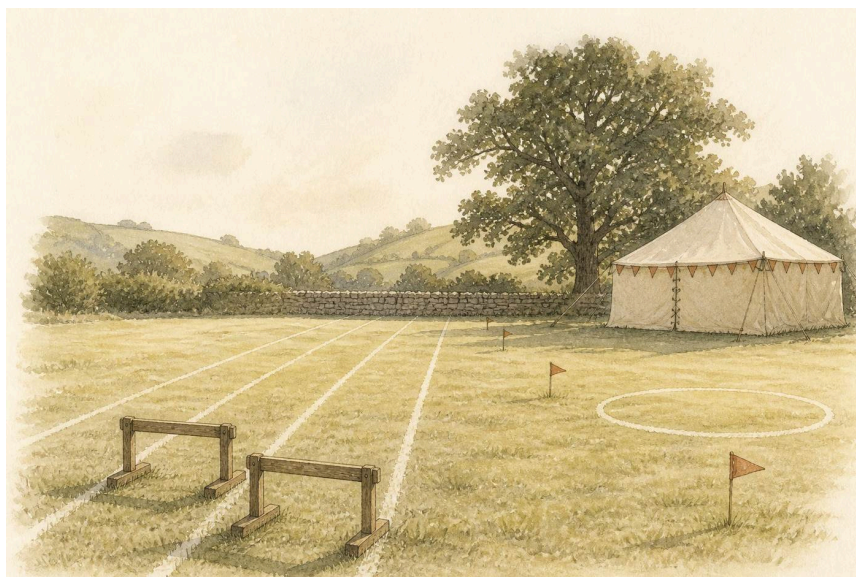
You are meant to. The pale boxes, the ruled lines and the timing tables are yours. Use a pencil, because your second attempt is usually a different number from your first, and that is the whole point.

Nothing in this book needs a screen

There is no code to scan and no page to look up. Everything you need is a body, a space, some cones and three other people. The addresses your teacher may want are in For teachers, at the back.

Getting set up

You do not need everything at once. Each part of the field tells you what to fetch.



The field before anybody arrives. Four lanes painted straight down the grass, two hurdles standing ready in the nearest lane, a chalked throwing circle off to one side and the marquee still laced shut. Look at how much space there is. By the middle of the morning there will be four events running on it at once.

Your field kit

- soft indoor shoes, or bare feet, or trainers, whichever your teacher says for the space
- a stopwatch, or one clock everybody can see
- eight cones, or eight of anything that stands up and does not roll away
- four bean bags, or four soft balls
- two hoops
- one low hurdle, or a cane resting on two cones at the lowest height you have
- a relay baton, or a rolled-up magazine, which works just as well
- chalk, or a roll of low-tack tape, for marking a line on the floor
- a pencil, because half of this book gets written in
- three other people, so that all four jobs are filled



Your kit, laid out. Not one thing here needs **a** screen. Count them against the list: shoes, **a** watch, **a** baton, four cones, two bean bags, **a** hoop, **a** tape and **a** clipboard. The clipboard belongs to whoever is watching.

Field rules

- 1 Walk into the space. Everybody walks in, every time, however exciting it is.
- 2 Look at the whole field before you move into it. Tuft is right about this and he is right every lesson.
- 3 Before you set off, know who else is moving and where they are going.
- 4 The timer says the number that is on the watch, not the number that would be kind.
- 5 A watcher says what they **saw**, never whether it was good.
- 6 The setter changes one thing at a time, tells nobody, and never changes anything dangerous.
- 7 Put the equipment back where it came from, at the end, without being asked.
- 8 Stop the moment you hear “stop”. Not after this one. Now.
- 9 Put your pencil down before you move. Write between goes, not during one.

► STAY SAFE

Before anybody moves, check four things and say them out loud:

The floor. Dry, clear, nothing to trip on, nothing to slide on. **The edges.** Nothing hard within two paces of any line you might run past. **The apparatus.** Every hurdle, hoop, bench and mat set out and tested by an adult, not by you. **The other groups.** Where they are working, and which way they are travelling.

If any of the four is wrong, you tell an adult and you do not begin.

Rule 6 is the one that is new, and it is worth knowing why the setter exists at all. Out in a game, in a match and on a real sports day, nobody tells you that the ground has changed. You find out because you were looking. A task where nothing ever changes trains you for a field that does not exist.

What you already bring

You do not arrive at the Grass Lanes empty-handed. Almost everything this unit asks for, you have already been taught, which is why the unit can spend its time on the four new words instead.

FROM	WHAT YOU LEARNED	WHERE YOU NEED IT HERE
Year 1	the movements themselves: running, jumping, hopping, skipping, landing, stopping, throwing, balancing	every station of the round of eight, in 1.1
Year 2	playing with a team on a marked court, in bibs	sharing the field, in 1.4
Year 3	practice: one thing to change, ten goes, and somebody watching that one thing	consolidating your two weakest, in 1.1
Year 3	joining movements so that there is no stop in the middle	four movements and three joins, in 1.2
Year 3	the four dials: speed, level, size and force	fluency and variety, in 1.3
Year 3	mover, timer and watcher, and swapping every time	all four jobs, all the way through

The four new words, and where they are

There are only four new ideas at the Grass Lanes, one for each lane. Everything else on the next thirty pages is something you can already do, being asked for in a harder way.

THE WORD	WHAT IT MEANS	LANE
consolidate	Keep a movement you have, instead of perfecting one movement and quietly losing three others	1.1
variety	Use movements from different families, and find more than one answer to the same task	1.2 and 1.3
fluency	Move with no pause you did not plan. Not the same as moving fast	1.3
other people	Read where somebody else is going, and give way on purpose rather than by accident	1.4

You have finished the Grass Lanes when

- ✓ you can say what all four words mean, and show each one with your body
- ✓ your sequence comes out the same twice, on purpose
- ✓ your hesitations reach nought, at whatever speed you choose
- ✓ another group can cross your field without either of you stopping

Nothing on that list is about being the fastest, and nothing on it compares you with anybody else. Every one of them compares you with your own earlier attempt, which is the only comparison this book is interested in.



UNIT 1 • GRASS LANES

1 Moving well

At the Grass Lanes you check that everything you can do is still there, link four movements into one short sequence, take the hesitations out of it, and then perform the whole thing on a field with other people moving on it.

✓ ON THIS FIELD YOU WILL

- ✓ check your whole range of movements, and consolidate the two weakest
- ✓ link four movements from four different families, with three joins
- ✓ perform a sequence twice with no hesitation and no difference
- ✓ read where other people are going, and give way on purpose

○ COME OUT TO THE FIELD

Think about October, at the start of this school year.

Now answer the harder question. **What could you do then that you have not done since?**

Almost everybody has something. A movement does not disappear, but it goes quiet, and a quiet movement is slower and wobblier than it used to be. This unit is about finding out which of yours have gone quiet, and about waking them up without losing the rest.

UNIT 1 – TOPIC 1.1

Keeping everything you can do

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Eight cones, four bean bags, two hoops, one low hurdle, a stopwatch and a pencil. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Travel anywhere in the space for ninety seconds, changing how you travel every time your teacher calls: walking, side-stepping, skipping, jogging. Never touch anybody and never stop.

Then five shoulder rolls backwards, five rises onto your toes, and stand still. Your body is warm and your ankles are awake. Cold practice is wasted practice.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip is a good thrower. He has been throwing all term and he is better at it than anybody.

Rowan asks the four of them to do a two-handed catch, a hop and a balance on one foot. Pip drops the catch, hops well, and puts a foot down out of the balance after two seconds.

“I can do all of those,” says Pip.

“You could do all of those in October,” says Willow.

► Learn

Your **range** is everything your body can do. It is much bigger than you think, and it is not all in the same condition.

Every movement in your range is in one of three states.

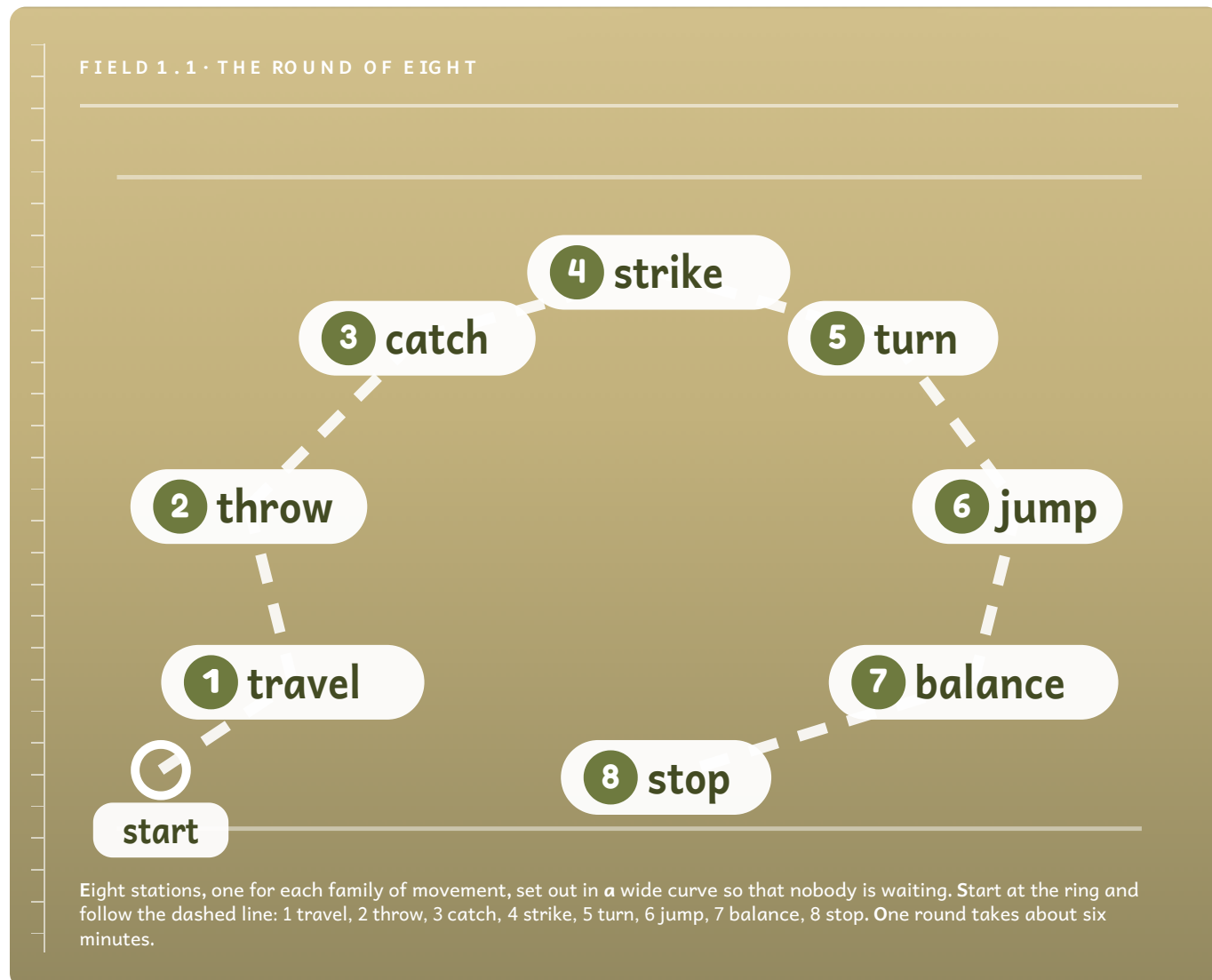
STATE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT IT NEEDS
new	You are still learning it. Some goes work and some do not.	Teaching, then practice
working	You can do it, but not every time, and not without thinking.	Consolidating
kept	You can do it today, first go, without warming up to it.	Using now and then

Consolidating means moving a movement from working to kept, and then keeping it there. It is the whole job of this topic, and it is not the same as practising one thing until it is beautiful, which is what you did last year.

Here is the difficulty. You cannot practise everything in one lesson. So you do this instead:

- ✓ **check** the whole range quickly, and be honest about the state of each part
- ✓ **choose** the two weakest, and only those two
- ✓ **consolidate** them properly, ten goes each, the way you learned last year
- ✓ **check again**, including things you already had, to be sure you did not lose them

That last step is the one everybody skips. A class that spends six weeks on throwing usually cannot catch as well at the end of it as at the beginning.



The eight stations are the eight **families** of movement you use in Year 4. Every movement you know belongs to one of them.

FAMILY	AT THE STATION YOU
travel	cross ten paces on your feet, any way you like, without slowing
throw	throw a bean bag to a partner, overarm, from six paces
catch	catch a bean bag thrown to you, with two hands, from six paces
strike or kick	send a ball between two cones from four paces

FAMILY	AT THE STATION YOU
turn	turn all the way round while travelling, without stopping
jump and land	jump into a hoop and land still
balance	hold a still shape on one foot to a count of five
stop	travel fast and stop dead on a chalk line, both feet behind it

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

The hardest event in athletics is not one event. The **decathlon** is ten of them, held over two days, and the order never changes. Day one: 100 metres, long jump, shot put, high jump, 400 metres. Day two: 110 metres hurdles, discus, pole vault, javelin, 1500 metres.

Read that list again and notice what it asks for. Sprinting, then jumping, then throwing, then sprinting again the next morning, on tired legs.

A decathlete's problem is never how to get good at one of the ten. It is how to keep all ten at once, which is exactly the problem on this page.



Halfway round. Bramble is at station 3 with the bean bag arriving, and his hands are already up and open, which is the one thing he set out to change. Behind him the next three stations are waiting: a hoop, two cones and a hurdle. Rowan has the second bag ready so that nobody stands about.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Bramble does the round of eight, and Willow writes down the state of each one honestly.

NO.	STATION	WHAT HAPPENED	STATE
1	travel	ten paces, no slowing	kept
2	throw	six of six reached Rowan	kept
3	catch	three of six, hands late twice	working
4	strike	four of six between the cones	kept
5	turn	turned, but slowed to do it	working
6	jump	into the hoop, landed still	kept
7	balance	five counts, no wobble	kept
8	stop	dead on the line, both feet behind	kept

Two are working the catch and the turn. So Bramble consolidates the **catch**, and he does it the Year 3 way: one thing to change, ten goes, somebody watching that one thing.

His one thing to change is hands up and ready before the bag arrives.

GO	HANDS	CAUGHT
1	came up as the bag arrived	no
4	up early, then dropped	yes
7	up early, stayed up	yes
10	up early, stayed up	yes

Then he does the part that matters most, and it takes two minutes: he goes back and repeats stations 2, 6 **and** 8, which were already kept

All three still are. That is the proof that he consolidated the catch instead of trading it for something else.

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Round one, station 3: hands started by his sides and came up as the bag arrived. Late, three times out of six.

Round two, station 3: hands up and open before Rowan let go. Caught all four.

Round two, stations 2, 6 and 8: same as round one. Nothing lost.

Notice the last line. A watcher's job in this topic is not only to watch the thing being practised. It is to check that the rest of the range came out the other side.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Do the round of eight. At each station, tick the state that is true today. Be honest: this table is only useful if it is.

NO.	STATION	NEW	WORKING	KEPT
1	travel	_____	_____	_____
2	throw	_____	_____	_____
3	catch	_____	_____	_____
4	strike	_____	_____	_____
5	turn	_____	_____	_____
6	jump	_____	_____	_____
7	balance	_____	_____	_____
8	stop	_____	_____	_____

- 2 Write your two weakest stations, and pick **one** of them to consolidate today.

My two weakest are _____

Today I will consolidate _____ and the one thing I will change is _____

3 Ten goes at that one station. Your watcher looks only at your one thing.

GO	WHAT THE WATCHER SAW	WORKED?
1	_____	_____
4	_____	_____
7	_____	_____
10	_____	_____

4 Now the step people skip. Go back to **three stations you scored as kept** and do them once each. Are they still kept?

STATION	STILL KEPT?	IF NOT, WHAT HAPPENED?
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____

5 Tick every one that is true.

- ☐ My weakest station moved from working towards kept.
- ☐ The three stations I checked again were still kept.
- ☐ I was more tired at the end, and one of them was worse because of that.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Swap jobs and score your partner's round of eight as the watcher, without telling them what you have written.

Then compare your table with theirs. Where you disagree, the movement is almost always working rather than kept: a mover feels the good goes and a watcher counts all of them.

UNIT 1 – TOPIC 1.2

Four movements, three joins

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Two hoops, one low hurdle, four cones, chalk or tape for one line, and a mat if your space has them. Work in fours.

○ DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.1, name the three states a movement in your range can be in.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel builds a sequence. She runs round the first cone, runs round the second cone, and runs round the third cone, fast and smoothly, and finishes on the line.

“Four movements,” says Sorrel. “Run, run, run, stop.”

“One movement three times, and then a stop,” says Willow.

► Learn

Last year a sequence was three movements with two joins in it. This year it is **four movements and three joins**, and there is a new rule about which four.

A **family** is a group of movements that do the same job: travelling, jumping, turning, balancing, throwing, catching, rolling, stopping. Sorrel's sequence used one family three times, which is why it did not count.

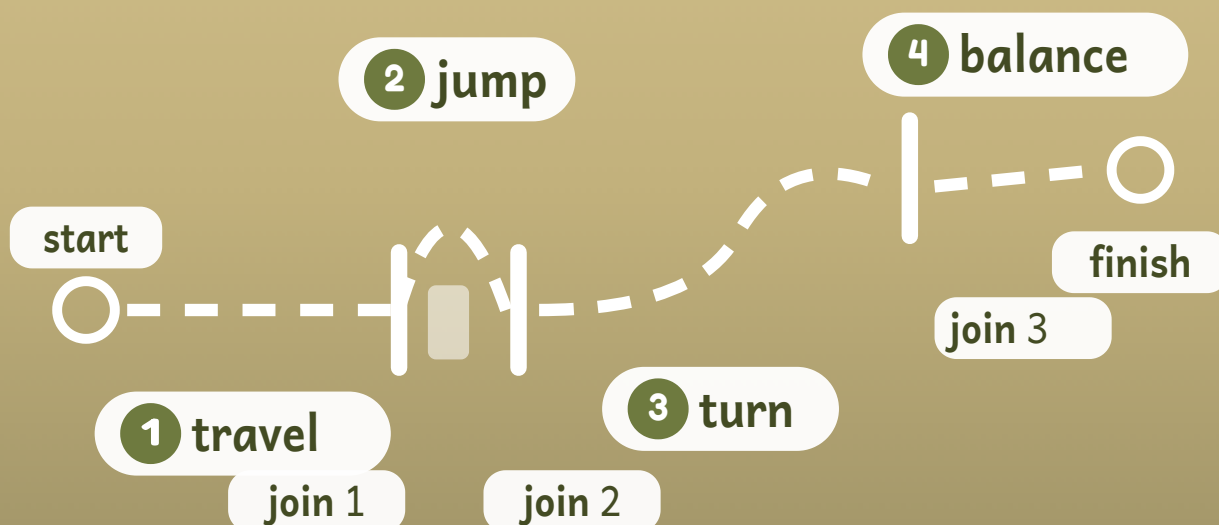
Two rules make a Year 4 sequence.

THE RULE	WHAT IT MEANS	WHY
Variety	The four movements come from four different families , and no family twice in a row	Linking a run to a run teaches you nothing. Linking a run to a balance is where the work is
Repeatable	You can perform it twice and a watcher cannot tell the two goes apart	A sequence you can only do once was luck, not a sequence

The joins are still the hard part, and now you have three of them. The middle one, join 2, is nearly always the weakest, because by then you have used up the speed the run gave you and you are not yet close enough to the end to be careful.

At every join, ask the Year 3 question: **can I begin the next movement from exactly where this one left me?** If the answer is no, the join is what you practise, not the movements.

FIELD 1.2 · FOUR MOVEMENTS, THREE JOINS



Four movements from four families, numbered 1 to 4, and the three thick upright marks between them are the joins. The pale rectangle is the low hurdle. Look at join 2: it is where the jump has to turn into a turn, and it is the one that goes wrong. The finish is a balance, held on the spot.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

A **4 by 100 metres relay** team is four runners and three baton changeovers, which is the same shape as the sequence on this page.

The baton has to be passed inside a marked takeover zone. Until 2017 that zone was a 20 metre box with a separate 10 metre acceleration zone in front of it. World Athletics then merged the two into a single **30 metre takeover zone**, which is what the rules say today.

Why change it? Because the changeovers are where relays are lost. Four fast runners with three poor joins are beaten by four ordinary runners who can pass a baton.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Pip builds run, hurdle, turn, balance. Four families, three joins.

Attempt 1. He runs, clears the hurdle, turns, and puts his foot down twice getting into the balance. Joins 1 and 2 worked. Join 3 failed: he arrived at the balance with too much speed left.

Attempt 2. He tightens the turn so that it takes the speed out for him, and arrives at the balance slower. Join 3 worked. Now join 2 is untidy, because the tighter turn needs him to land the hurdle facing further round.

Attempt 3. He lands the hurdle with his shoulders already turning, tightens the turn, and arrives at the balance ready. All three joins worked.

Attempt 4. He does the whole thing again and Willow cannot tell attempt 4 from attempt 3.

Attempt 4 is the one that counts. Attempts 1 to 3 built the sequence; attempt 4 proved he owns it.



Join 2, while he is still in the air. Look at Pip's head and his front paws. Both point at the hoop lying on the grass ahead of him, not down at the bar he is crossing. **He** has already begun the next movement. **Bramble** has the clipboard, and notice that he is writing between goes rather than during one.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Build a sequence of four movements from **four different families**. Write your four in order, and write the family beside each one.

OUR SEQUENCE	
1	
2	
3	
4	

Three joins. Mark each one with an arrow.

- 2 Perform it twice. Your watcher does not judge it: they say which **join** was different between go 1 and go 2.

THE JOIN THAT DIFFERED	WHAT WAS DIFFERENT ABOUT IT
------------------------	-----------------------------

--	--

- 3 Now practise that one join, four times, and perform the whole sequence twice more.

GO	WEAKEST JOIN	COULD A WATCHER TELL THE TWO GOES APART?
----	--------------	--

1		
2		

- 4 Tick every one that is true of your last go.

- ☐ Four movements, from four different families.
- ☐ No stop at any of the three joins.
- ☐ My two performances were the same as each other.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Perform your sequence twice, one straight after the other, so that a watcher who has never seen it cannot say which go was which.

If they can tell, do not explain. Ask them which join gave it away, practise that join, and go again. A sequence that comes out differently every time is still working not kept

UNIT 1 – TOPIC 1.3**Fluent, not fast****▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

Four cones, two hoops, one low hurdle, a stopwatch and a pencil. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Cross the space four times without stopping at either end: walking, side-stepping, skipping, jogging. The turn at the end counts as part of the crossing, so do not stop to do it.

Almost everybody stops at the turn on the first two crossings. Notice when you do.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel performs her four-movement sequence in nine seconds. It looks rushed.

Tuft performs his in fourteen seconds. It looks finished.

Willow is not timing them. She is counting something else, and her numbers are Sorrel three and Tuft nought.

► Learn

Willow is counting **hesitations**.

A hesitation is a pause you did not plan. It is not the same as a slow movement. A slow movement is a choice you made, and it can be perfectly fluent.

Fluency means the whole sequence runs without hesitations and without gaps: every movement begins from where the last one left you.

Three things cause hesitations, and they need three different fixes.

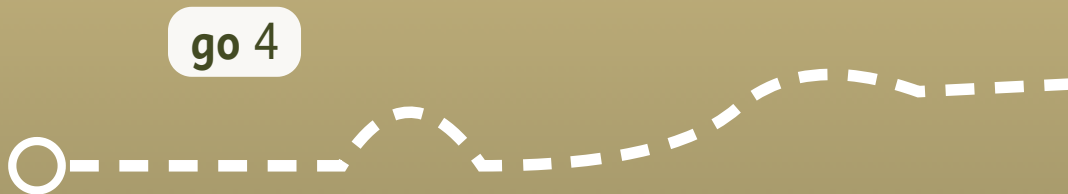
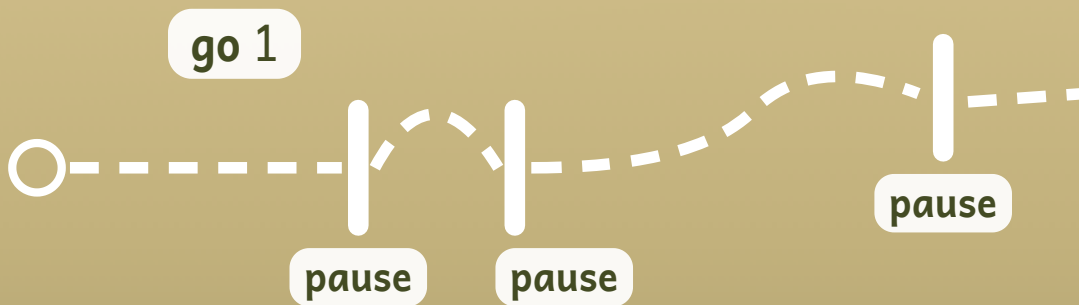
THE CAUSE	WHAT IT LOOKS LIKE	THE FIX
You are looking for the next thing	A small pause with the head turning	Learn the order until you do not have to think about it
You arrived somewhere you cannot leave	A pause with the feet shuffling	Change the finish of the movement before it
You changed your mind	A pause, then something different from the plan	Decide before you start, and perform the plan you decided

Now the second half of this topic, and it is a new word too. **Variety** means solving the same task in more than one way. Two goes that are equally fluent but **different** prove more than one perfect go, because they show you understood the task rather than memorised one answer.

FAST	FLUENT
Measured with a stopwatch	Counted in hesitations
Can be got by hurrying	Cannot be got by hurrying
Usually looks rushed at this age	Looks finished, at any speed
One setting only	Works at any speed you choose

Q DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Year 3, name the four dials you can change without changing the movement itself.



one unbroken line, same route, same speed

Both routes are the same four movements. The three thick bars across go 1 are hesitations: pauses nobody planned. On go 4 the paint is one unbroken line. Nothing has been done faster. The gaps have simply gone.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Carlos Lopes ran the marathon for Portugal. He won the Olympic marathon in Los Angeles in 1984, in an Olympic record of 2 hours 9 minutes and 21 seconds, and he finished about 200 metres ahead of everybody else. He was 37 years old.

The following April, at the age of 38, he set the world record for the marathon in Rotterdam: 2 hours 7 minutes and 12 seconds. He was the last European to hold that record, and he held it for three years.

Look at the words “Olympic record” again. That is not a burst of speed somewhere in the middle. It is 42 kilometres held together without a single gap, which is what this whole page is about.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Tuft performs his sequence three times. Bramble times him. Willow counts the hesitations only.

GO	TIME	HESITATIONS	WHERE, AND WHY
1	14 s	2	after the jump, looking for the hoop; before the balance, feet shuffling
2	13 s	1	before the balance, still arriving too fast
3	13 s	0	none. He turned tighter, so he arrived ready

Read the middle column, then read the one beside it.

One second separates go 1 from go 3, and a second is nothing. What actually changed is that two pauses disappeared. If Bramble had only had the stopwatch, he would have reported that Tuft got almost nothing better.

Then Tuft does the **variety** half. He performs the same task with a different answer: he swaps the jump for a roll and takes the turn the other way.

Same task, different sequence, and still no hesitations. Now he can prove he understood the task, and not just remembered one route.

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Go 1: paused after the jump and looked across at the hoop before setting off again. Paused again before the balance, two small steps.

Go 3: no pause anywhere. Came off the jump already facing the hoop, and arrived at the balance slowly enough to hold it first time.

Second version: different movements, same shape, no pauses. He did not go faster. He stopped stopping.

Willow never writes “much better”. She writes what the head did, what the feet did and where the pause was. That is why Tuft knew which second to work on.



Even, and in no hurry. Sorrel is the fastest in the class and this is her working on the harder thing. Look at her shoulders: they are level, and she is upright. She is not slowing down and she is not speeding up, which is what a fluent middle of a sequence looks like.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Perform your sequence from 1.2 three times. Your timer writes the time. Your watcher counts **only** the hesitations, and says where each one was.

GO	TIME	HESITATIONS	WHERE WAS THE FIRST ONE?
1	_____	_____	_____
2	_____	_____	_____
3	_____	_____	_____

2 Which of the three causes was your first hesitation? Tick one.

☐ I was looking for the next thing.

☐ I arrived somewhere I could not leave.

☐ I changed my mind.

3 How much did your **time** change between go 1 and go 3, and how much did your **hesitations** change?

Time changed by _____ Hesitations changed by _____

4 Now the variety half. Perform the same task a **different way**: change two of the four movements, or take the route the other way round. Write both versions.

VERSION	THE FOUR MOVEMENTS	HESITATIONS
A	_____	_____
B	_____	_____

5 Tick what is true.

☐ My hesitations went down while my time stayed about the same.

☐ Both my versions were fluent.

☐ One version was fluent and the other one is not finished yet.

→ GO A LITTLE FURTHER

Perform your fluent version with one dial turned right down: as slowly as you possibly can, holding that speed all the way through.

The hesitations usually come back, and that is worth knowing. Slow is where a gap shows, which is exactly why judges ask gymnasts to perform slowly.

UNIT 1 – TOPIC 1.4

A field with other people on it

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Eight cones, four bean bags, two hoops, one low hurdle and chalk. Work in fours, then two fours together on one field.

► STAY SAFE

From here to the end of the unit, more than one group works on the same field. Four rules, and none of them is negotiable.

- 1 **Look at the whole field before you set off**, not only at your own route.
- 2 **Decide before you move.** At any place where two routes cross, agree who changes their line and who changes their timing.
- 3 **One mover on any piece of apparatus at a time.** Wait behind a cone, never beside the hurdle.
- 4 **If you are about to arrive together, both slow down.** Nobody wins a crossing.

○ DO YOU REMEMBER?

From 1.3, what exactly is a hesitation?

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan sets out one hoop for two groups to share.

Tuft and Rowan set off at the same moment, both heading for the hoop. Both stop. Both apologise. Both wait. Both set off again.

It happens again.

“Twice,” says Willow. “You are both being polite, and neither of you is deciding.”

► Learn

This is the topic that makes Year 4 different from Year 3. Last year one body moved at a time. From now on the field is shared, and there are two new things to handle: **other people**, and **a ground that changes while you work**.

Before you set off, read three things about everybody else who is moving.

READ	THE QUESTION	HOW YOU FIND OUT
Where	Where are they going?	Look at their feet and their shoulders, not their face
When	Will they get there before me, with me, or after me?	Count: one, two, three, as you both travel
What job	What are they doing, and what are they allowed to do?	The task, or the rules of the game

Then use the rule that stops the scenario above from happening for ever.

At a crossing point, one of you changes line and the other changes timing.

If you both change line you meet in the new place. If you both change timing you both stop, which is what Tuft and Rowan kept doing. It does not matter which of you does

which, and it does not have to be fair every time. It has to be **decided**.

There is one more thing, and it is the setter’s job. In a real game nobody warns you that the ground has changed. So the setter moves one thing while you work, and you use the Year 3 rule: **keep the movement, change the detail**.

KIND OF ACTIVITY	WHO DECIDES WHO GIVES WAY	EXAMPLE
You choose it (self-selected)	You do, out loud, before you move	Two groups sharing one field for their sequences
Structured	The rules do	In a game, the player without the ball usually gives way

FIELD 1.4 · ONE CROSSING, TWO WAYS TO SOLVE IT

you



them

you both want this

change your LINE



they keep theirs

change your TIMING



wait one count

On the left, two routes cross and the double ring is the place you both want at the same moment. In the middle, you curve behind and they hold their line. On the right, you keep your line and wait one count at the short bar. Both work. Doing both at once does not.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Futsal is football played five against five on a hard court 40 metres long and 20 metres wide, about the size of a handball court. The court, the ball and the rules all favour close control and passing in small spaces.

Ten players inside 800 square metres means somebody is always about to cross your line, so a futsal player reads the other nine almost constantly.

Portugal won the Futsal World Cup in 2021, in Lithuania, beating Argentina 2 to 1 in the final. It was the first time Portugal had won it.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Rowan puts one hoop out for two groups. Tuft and Rowan both need it.

Attempt 1. Both set off. Both stop. Both wait. Nothing happens. Nobody decided.

Attempt 2. They decide first: Rowan holds his line, Tuft changes his timing and waits one count before setting off. Both get to the hoop, one after the other, and neither stops once they are moving.

Attempt 3. They swap. Tuft holds his line and Rowan curves behind him, changing his line instead. It works just as well, and Rowan travels slightly further.

Attempt 4. While they are working, Rowan the setter moves the hoop two paces to the left without telling anybody. Tuft sees it as he sets off, changes one detail, a longer first stride, and keeps the sequence. Nothing else about his movement changes.

Attempt 4 is the Year 4 objective in one go: the ground changed, and the movement survived it.



Two routes, one crossing. Find the two painted lines meeting in the grass in front of them. Rowan is holding his line straight across it. Tuft, who agreed to change his timing, is travelling but has not gone into the gap yet, and he is watching Rowan while he waits. Clear grass between them, and neither of them has stopped.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Two groups, one field. Draw both routes on the field below: yours as a dashed line, the other group's as a dotted line with an arrow. Ring the place you both want.

BOTH ROUTES, SEEN FROM ABOVE, WITH THE CROSSING RINGED

- 2 Decide **before** anybody moves, and write it down.

At our crossing, _____ changes line and
 _____ changes timing.

- 3 Three goes. After each one, write what you read and what you changed.

GO	WHAT I READ ABOUT THE OTHER GROUP	WHAT I CHANGED	DID ANYBODY STOP?
1			
2			
3			

- 4 On go 3, the setter changes one thing without telling you. Write what changed, and the one detail of your movement you changed to deal with it.

What the setter changed

The one detail I changed

- 5 Tick every one that is true.

- ☐ We decided who gives way before we moved, not while we were moving.
- ☐ Nobody stopped and nobody touched anybody.
- ☐ The ground changed and I kept my sequence.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Perform your sequence while two other groups cross the same field, and keep all four movements, all three joins and nought hesitations.

Then swap: be one of the groups crossing while somebody else performs. It is harder, and it is the half everybody forgets to practise.

The sports day

Six friends, four jobs, one field, and everything from the Grass Lanes at once.

You will check your range, build a short sequence, take the hesitations out of it, perform it on a shared field while other people move, and have a watcher describe it back to you. Your work is finished when the watcher’s description matches what you meant to do.

A SPORTS DAY SEQUENCE IS GOOD WHEN	IT IS WEAK WHEN
the four movements come from four different families	it uses one family twice in a row
it can be performed twice with no difference a watcher can name	it comes out differently every time
it runs with nought hesitations	it has pauses nobody planned
it survives another group crossing the field	it only works on an empty field
it survives the setter moving one thing	it falls apart when a cone moves
a watcher can describe it without asking you	you have to explain it first



The sports day. Three of them performing, three of them watching, and the watchers have the clipboards. Nobody is being marked and nobody is winning. Everybody is being described.

THE SPORTS DAY • THE FIVE STEPS

- 1 **Check what you have.** One round of eight. Write the state of each station, and consolidate the weakest one before you build anything.
- 2 **Build it.** Four movements from four families, three joins, on a field you draw before you move.
- 3 **Make it flow.** Perform it until the hesitations reach nought. Your timer times it, but the hesitation count is the number that matters.
- 4 **Share the field.** Perform it while another group crosses. Decide the crossing before anybody moves. The setter changes one thing on the last go.
- 5 **Be described.** A watcher writes down all four movements, all three joins, the hesitations and what you did about the other group, without speaking to you.

What good looks like: their description and your plan say the same thing.

Step 5 is the one that matters, and it is the one everybody wants to argue about. If the watcher wrote “then he sort of waited for the other group”, you did wait. The watcher is not being unfair. They are being a mirror, which is the most useful thing a person can be.

Our sequence, written down before we move

OUR SPORTS DAY SEQUENCE

1

2

3

4

The weakest station we consolidated first, and the crossing we agreed:

OUR FIELD, DRAWN BEFORE WE MOVED

WHAT THE WATCHER WROTE AFTERWARDS

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Four movements: a run, a jump off the hurdle, a turn, and a balance held on one foot.

Joins 1 and 3 were clean. Join 2 had a small pause in it on the first go and none on the second.

Hesitations: one, then nought.

The other group crossed after his jump. He changed his timing, waited one count, and did not lose the turn.

Held the balance past three. Same sequence both times.

That is what a full description looks like. It names the movements, judges each join separately, counts the hesitations, says what happened at the crossing, and says what the finish did. Not one word of it says whether Willow enjoyed it.

How did it go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet. Answer for today, not for your best ever go.

AT THE GRASS LANES	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I checked my whole range honestly, and named my two weakest	☐ ☐ ☐
I consolidated one of them, and did not lose the others	☐ ☐ ☐
My sequence used four movements from four different families	☐ ☐ ☐

AT THE GRASS LANES	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I performed it twice and a watcher could not tell them apart	☐ ☐ ☐
My hesitations reached nought	☐ ☐ ☐
I solved the same task a second, different way	☐ ☐ ☐
I decided a crossing before I moved, and kept moving	☐ ☐ ☐
The setter changed something and I kept my sequence	☐ ☐ ☐
As a watcher, I said what I saw instead of saying “good”	☐ ☐ ☐
As a setter, I changed one thing fairly and never anything dangerous	☐ ☐ ☐

The last two rows are worth as much as the eight about moving. A class where nobody watches properly is a class where nobody improves, because there is no way to find out whether anything changed. And a class where the setter cheats is a class that stops trusting the task.

☐ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ check my whole range of movements, and say which are kept and which are working
- ☐ consolidate a working movement without losing the ones I already had
- ☐ name the eight families of movement
- ☐ link four movements from four different families with three joins
- ☐ perform the same sequence twice with no difference a watcher can name
- ☐ count hesitations, in my own performance and in somebody else's
- ☐ tell the difference between moving fast and moving fluently
- ☐ solve the same movement task in two different ways
- ☐ read where another person is going, when they will get there, and what their job is
- ☐ decide a crossing before I move, by changing my line or my timing

☐ keep my movement when the ground changes underneath it



UNIT 2 · JUDGES TABLE

2 Understanding movement

At the Judges table you learn the words for what a body did, you name action, dynamic, space and relationship, you judge against a criterion instead of a feeling, and you use a simple tactic inside a real game.

✓ ON THIS FIELD YOU WILL

- ✓ describe a movement with words a watcher can check
- ✓ change one of four things on purpose: action, dynamic, space, relationship
- ✓ apply a success criterion to your own go and to a partner's
- ✓ follow a rule, then use one tactic, in a small sided game

○ COME OUT TO THE FIELD

Last unit you did the movement. This unit you have to say what the movement did, so clearly that a person who was looking at something else can still picture it.

If you can only say “it was good”, you have not started yet.

UNIT 2 – TOPIC 2.1

The words a judge uses

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A clipboard, a pencil, four cones and a bean bag. Work in fours: mover, timer, watcher, setter.

+ WARM UP

Travel for sixty seconds. Each time the teacher claps, freeze. The freeze must be still enough that a watcher can name the shape.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip finishes a catch and looks at Willow.

“Was it good?” he says.

Willow writes for a long time. Then she reads: “Hands met the bag in front of your chest. Left foot stepped in. You did not bring it in to your body.”

Pip waits for the bit that says whether she liked it. It does not come.

► Learn

A **judge’s word** names a body part, a place, or a count. It never names a feeling.

NOT A JUDGE'S WORD	A JUDGE'S WORD
good, bad, nice, better	hands met the bag in front of the chest
try harder	three of five reached the target
that was amazing	the land was still for a count of three
almost	the left foot stepped in, the right did not

Year 3 asked you to say whether a movement worked. Year 4 asks you to say **what the body did**, so the mover knows which one thing to change.

Three families of judge's words, and you need all three:

- ✓ **body** : which part moved, and where it finished
- ✓ **place** : where on the field it happened
- ✓ **count** : how many, how long, how far

If a sentence has none of those three, it is an opinion, and it does not go on the clipboard.

FIELD 2.1 · THREE COLUMNS A JUDGE ACTUALLY FILLS

body
which part

place
where it was

count
how many

A judge's sentence always has something from at least two of these three boxes. "Hands up before the bag arrived, six of six" uses body and count. "Nice throw" uses none of them.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Football referees do not write “that was a bad challenge”. The Laws of the Game ask them to name **what happened**: careless, reckless, or using excessive force. Three words, and each one has a different consequence.

A Year 4 watcher is not a referee. The habit is the same. Name the thing. Do not name the feeling.



Willow is not watching the whole catch. Look at her eyes: they are on Pip's hands, which is the one thing they agreed. The clipboard has three short lines, not a paragraph. Bramble has the bag ready for the next go.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow watches Pip's catch. She is allowed to write **one** sentence.

Go 1. She writes: good catch. Rowan crosses it out. No body, no place, no count.

Go 2. She writes: hands late. Body, but no place and no count. Better, still not enough.

Go 3. She writes: hands met the bag at chest height, four of six. Body, place, count. Pip now knows what to change: bring the hands up earlier, and he can count whether it worked.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Watch a partner throw a bean bag to a target four paces away, five times. Write one judge's sentence. It must have a body part and a count.

- 2 Swap. Your partner watches you. Tick which boxes their sentence filled.

☐ body

☐ place

☐ count

- 3 Rewrite the weakest sentence in the group so that it fills two boxes.

Before:

After:

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Watch a modified football pass, a basketball bounce pass and a net throw, one of each. Write three judge's sentences, and none of them may reuse a word from another. If you wrote "accurate" three times, you have not done it.

► STAY SAFE

Stand still when you are the watcher. A moving watcher is a body on the field that nobody is reading.

UNIT 2 – TOPIC 2.2

Action, dynamic, space, relationship

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Four cones, two hoops, one bean bag. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Cross the space four ways: walk, skip, side-step, jog. Freeze on a clap. Name, out loud, whether you were travelling or still.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft copies Sorrel's sequence exactly, he thinks. Same four movements, same order.

Willow says they were different.

"I did what she did," says Tuft.

"You did the same **actions**," says Willow. "You did not do the same anything else."

► Learn

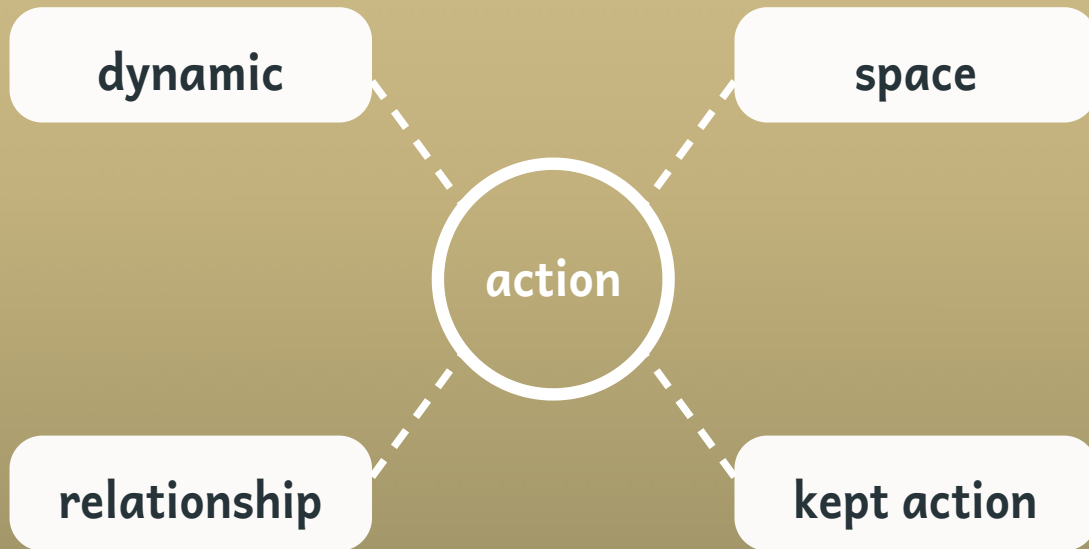
Every movement can be named with four words. Year 3 met them as dials. Year 4 uses their proper names, because a judge has to say **which dial moved**.

WORD	WHAT IT ASKS	A CHANGE LOOKS LIKE
action	What did the body do?	run, jump, turn, throw, catch, balance
dynamic	How was it done?	fast or slow, strong or light, sudden or smooth
space	Where did it travel?	high or low, forwards or sideways, a short path or a long one
relationship	Who or what was it with?	alone, beside a partner, towards a ball, away from a person

If you change the action, you have made a new movement. If you keep the action and change one of the other three, you have made a **variation**, which is the Year 4 skill.

A game uses all four at once. A bounce pass is an action. A bounce pass played softly into space ahead of a moving partner has changed dynamic, space and relationship without changing the action.

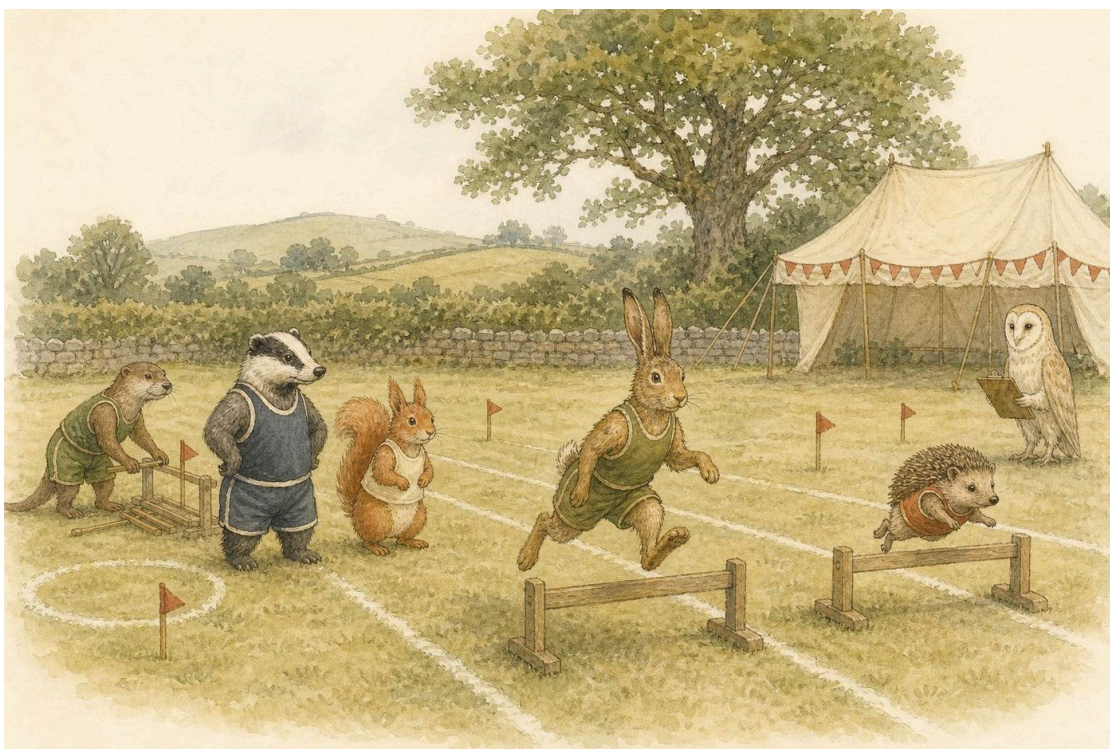
FIELD 2.2 · FOUR DIALS, ONE ACTION KEPT



The action in the middle stays the same. Each white card is a dial you can turn without inventing a new movement. Year 4 asks you to turn one dial on purpose and to name which one you turned.

○ DO YOU REMEMBER?

Name the four dials from Year 3.



Same jump, different space. Sorrel is jumping the hurdle along the lane, which is the action she already owns. Tuft is jumping the same hurdle but sideways, which is **a** space change, not **a** new action. Willow has written “space” on the clipboard and nothing else.

■ WATCH ME TRY

The action is a two-handed catch.

Dynamic. Pip catches it softly, then catches it as if the bag were heavy. Same hands, different how.

Space. Bramble catches it high, then catches it at his knees. Same action, different where.

Relationship. Tuft catches it alone, then catches it while Rowan is running across his line. Same action, different who.

Willow’s notes name the dial, not the catch. That is the whole topic.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Keep one action. Change **only** the dynamic, then **only** the space, then **only** the relationship. Write which dial you turned.

GO	DIAL I TURNED	WHAT IT LOOKED LIKE
1	_____	_____
2	_____	_____
3	_____	_____

- 2 Watch a partner. Name the dial they turned. If you name the action, you have not done the task.

They turned _____

- 3 In a three-against-three passing game (football, handball or basketball rules, your teacher's choice), call out the dial **before** you pass: "space" if you pass into a gap, "relationship" if you pass to a moving partner.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Build a four-movement sequence in which the **action** stays in the same family and the other three dials each change once. A watcher must be able to name which go changed which dial.

UNIT 2 – TOPIC 2.3

Judging against a criterion

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Clipboard, pencil, five bean bags, a hoop. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Five throws to a hoop from four paces. After each one, your watcher says only "in" or "out". No other words.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel scores four out of five. Pip scores two out of five.

“I won,” says Sorrel.

“Did you?” says Rowan. “The criterion was hands ready before the bag left my hand. You scored four, and your hands came up as the bag arrived, every time. Pip scored two, and his hands were up first, five times out of five.”

► Learn

A **criterion** is the one thing you agreed to look at **before** anybody moved. It is not the score. It is not whether you liked it.

Year 3 used “what good looks like” as a feeling at the end. Year 4 writes the criterion at the top of the clipboard, and the score sits underneath it, because a high score with the wrong body is not the objective.

IF THE CRITERION IS	THEN YOU IGNORE	AND YOU COUNT
hands up before the bag travels	whether it went in	how often the hands were early
land still for three counts	how far you jumped	whether the land held
pass into space, not at feet	who “won” the game	how many passes arrived in a gap

You may only judge what you wrote down. A watcher who adds a second criterion in the middle has started a different task.

FIELD 2.3 · CRITERION FIRST, SCORE SECOND

CRITERION (written first)

one body thing, agreed before go 1

SCORE (counted second)

The top box is decided while everybody is still standing still. The bottom box is the only number that is allowed to move. If you fill them in the other order, you are guessing afterwards.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

In athletics, the long jump is not won by the person who looks the most like a jumper. It is won by the longest legal mark. The criterion is written in the rules: take-off from behind the board, land in the pit, measurement from the nearest mark in the sand.

A beautiful jump that fouls is a foul. The feeling is not the criterion.



The clipboard is the lesson. Rowan has written one line at the top before Pip has thrown. Pip is looking at that line, not at the hoop. The hoop is how they will check the score. The line is how they will check the criterion.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Criterion: the thrower steps forward with the opposite foot to the throwing arm.

Pip, five goes, right-handed. Watcher: Willow.

GO	OPPOSITE FOOT	IN THE HOOP
1	no	yes
2	yes	no
3	yes	yes
4	yes	yes
5	yes	no

If they had only counted the hoop, Pip would have scored three and thought he was done. Against the criterion he scored four, and the one miss of the foot was go 1, which is the one he needed to know about.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write a criterion for a standing long jump. It must name a body part.
- 2 Five goes. Fill both columns. The criterion column is the one that decides whether you improved.

GO	CRITERION: YES OR NO	DISTANCE OR SCORE
1	_____	_____
3	_____	_____
5	_____	_____

- 3 Set a partner a new criterion for a bounce pass (basketball) or a push pass (hockey). Watch five goes. Tell them only the criterion count, not whether you liked it.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Swap criteria with another group without telling the movers what the new one is. After five goes, the movers have to guess the criterion from the watcher's numbers alone. If they can guess it, the watching was specific enough.

UNIT 2 – TOPIC 2.4

Rules, tactics and the plan inside a game

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One soft ball, six cones, four bibs. Four against four, small pitch. Football, handball or a mixed invasion game: your teacher names the rules before you start.

+ WARM UP

Two minutes of passing in fours, one-touch if you can, two-touch if you cannot. No tackling. The warm-up is for the hands and the feet, not for winning.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The four of them play three-against-three. They all chase the ball. The ball is always where they all are, and the rest of the pitch is empty.

Rowan stands still in a gap and calls. Nobody passes.

"I was open," he says.

"We were playing," says Pip.

► Learn

A **rule** is something you may not break. A **tactic** is a plan you choose, inside the rules, to make the next few seconds easier.

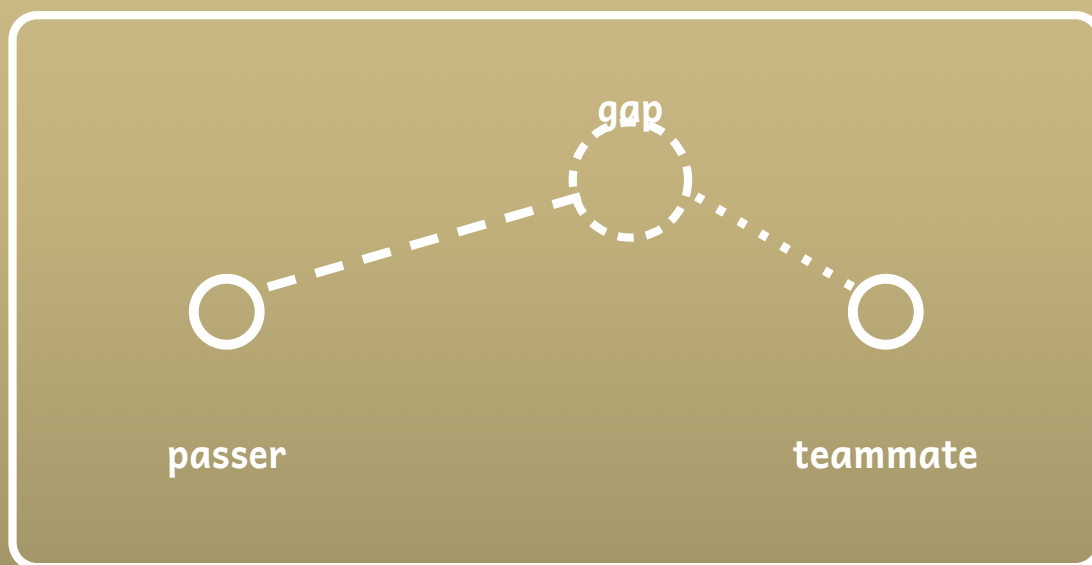
Year 3 taught you to follow simple rules. Year 4 asks you to use a rule as a tool: the offside-free small game, the no-contact rule, the “three passes before a shot” rule. Each one changes what a good choice looks like.

Three Year 4 tactics, and they are enough:

TACTIC	WHAT YOU ACTUALLY DO	WHAT IT IS FOR
create space	move away from the ball, into a gap	so a pass has somewhere to go
use space	pass into the gap, not at a teammate’s feet	so they can receive on the move
move after passing	do not stand where you released it	so you are not marking yourself

Defending in Year 4 is not tackling. It is **marking space**: standing between the ball and the goal, or between the ball and the person you are looking after, without touching them.

FIELD 2.4 · THE BALL, THE GAP, AND THE PASS INTO IT



The solid ring with the ball is the passer. The dashed ring is empty grass. The dotted line is the teammate running into that grass. The pass is drawn to the gap, not to where the teammate is standing now. That is using space.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Futsal, which you met in Unit 1, is built on this. Five players on a 40 by 20 metre court have almost no empty grass unless somebody **leaves** the ball. The player without the ball is the one who creates the next pass. Portugal's 2021 Futsal World Cup side won that way, not by everyone running at the ball.



The gap is the tactic. Find the empty grass between Pip, who has the ball, and Bramble, who has already started running into it. Sorrel, defending, is marking the space in front of the cones, not chasing Pip. Nobody is touching anybody.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Rule: three passes before anyone may shoot. Tactic: create space.

Go 1. All four chase the ball. They complete one pass. The other team take it.

Go 2. Rowan stands in a gap and does not move towards the ball. Pip sees him, passes, and then moves. Three passes. A shot. Still messy, but the plan existed.

Go 3. The setter (Willow, with the teacher's leave) shrinks the pitch by two paces. The same tactic still works. The rule still holds. The movement got smaller. The idea did not.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Name the rule of your game in one sentence, and the one tactic your team will use.

Rule:

Tactic:

- 2 Play five minutes. After each stoppage, the watcher writes which tactic they saw, or writes “none” if everybody chased the ball.

MINUTE	TACTIC SEEN	WHO CREATED SPACE?
1	_____	_____
3	_____	_____
5	_____	_____

- 3 Swap: your team defends space only. No taking the ball with your hands. Count how many times the other team passed into an empty gap.

Gaps they used: _____

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Play the same game with one new rule: you may not pass back to the person who just passed to you. That single rule forces movement after passing. If the game gets slower, the tactic is not in yet. If it gets quicker, it is.

► STAY SAFE

Small sided, no sliding, no tackling from behind. If you cannot see the person you are running towards, you do not run there. The teacher stops the game on one long whistle; everybody stops on that sound, including the person with the ball.

The programme of events

Four topics, one clipboard, and a short game that has a rule and a tactic in it.

You will describe a movement with judge’s words, turn one dial on purpose, apply a criterion you wrote first, and then use one tactic inside a rule. The work is finished when a watcher who has only the clipboard can tell what you meant to do.

THE PROGRAMME IS GOOD WHEN	IT IS WEAK WHEN
every sentence has a body, a place or a count	the clipboard says “good”
the dial you turned is named	you changed everything at once
the criterion was written before go 1	you invented it after the score
the tactic is visible to a watcher	everybody chased the ball



Four clipboards, one field. The judges are not sitting in a row being important. They are standing where they can see the one thing they agreed to watch. The game is still a game. The clipboard is how the game becomes a lesson.

THE PROGRAMME OF EVENTS • THE FIVE STEPS

- 1 **Name it.** Watch one go and write a judge's sentence with a body part and a count.
- 2 **Turn one dial.** Keep the action. Change dynamic, space or relationship, and write which.

- 3 **Write the criterion first.** Five goes. Criterion column, then score column.
- 4 **Play the plan.** One rule, one tactic, three-against-three or four-against-four.
- 5 **Be described.** A watcher reads the clipboard back. If it matches what you meant, the unit is done.

What good looks like: the clipboard and the game say the same thing.

* **WILLOW'S OWN NOTES**

Judge's sentence: hands met the bag at chest height, four of six.

Dial turned: space. He caught the last two at his knees on purpose.

Criterion: opposite foot. Four of five. Score in the hoop: three of five.

Tactic: Rowan stood in a gap and Pip passed to the gap, not to his feet. Twice.

The rest of the time they chased the ball.

That is a programme of events. It does not say whether Willow enjoyed the lesson.

How did it go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet.

AT THE JUDGES TABLE	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I described a movement with a body part and a count	☐ ☐ ☐
I turned one dial on purpose and named it	☐ ☐ ☐
I wrote a criterion before anybody moved	☐ ☐ ☐
I used one tactic inside a rule, not just chased the ball	☐ ☐ ☐
A watcher could read my clipboard and know what I meant	☐ ☐ ☐

☐ **LOOK WHAT I CAN DO**

- ☐ I can describe a movement without using good, bad or nice.

- ☐ I can keep an action and change dynamic, space or relationship.
- ☐ I can apply a criterion I wrote first.
- ☐ I can name a rule and a tactic in a small sided game.
- ☐ I can create space, use space, or move after a pass, on purpose.



UNIT 3 · OPEN FIELD

3 Moving creatively

At the Open field you invent a movement nobody showed you and use it in five kinds of work, you design three answers to the same challenge, you solve a task with your body, and you compose a short phrase that feels like weather.

✓ ON THIS FIELD YOU WILL

- ✓ invent a movement and use it alone, with a group, to express, to compete and to help
- ✓ design three answers to one challenge, then select one and say why
- ✓ solve a given task, then write a task of your own
- ✓ build a short phrase with a motif that returns, and change its mood

○ COME OUT TO THE FIELD

Last unit you had to say what the movement did. This unit the field is open, and nobody is going to show you the answer first.

Year 3 asked you to explore: find a movement, try the apparatus, answer a short task, move like a storm. Year 4 asks you to **design**. Design means you invent more than one answer, you choose, and you can tell a watcher why.

If you only have one idea, you have not started yet.

UNIT 3 – TOPIC 3.1

A movement nobody showed you

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

An empty patch of grass about ten metres square, four cones, one scarf. Work in fours: mover, timer, watcher, setter.

+ WARM UP

Travel for sixty seconds. Every time the teacher claps, change the body part that leads: feet, then a hip, then a shoulder, then the top of the head. Freeze on the second whistle. The freeze must be a shape you chose, not a collapse.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan says, "Show me a travel I have not taught you this year."

Pip skips. It is a good skip. It is also last year's skip.

Tuft travels on two hands and one foot, sideways, and stops in a still shape.

"That one is new," says Willow. "Now do it as a team. Then do it to help somebody. Then do it in a game."

Pip looks at her. "It is the same movement."

"It is the same idea," says Willow. "It is not the same work."

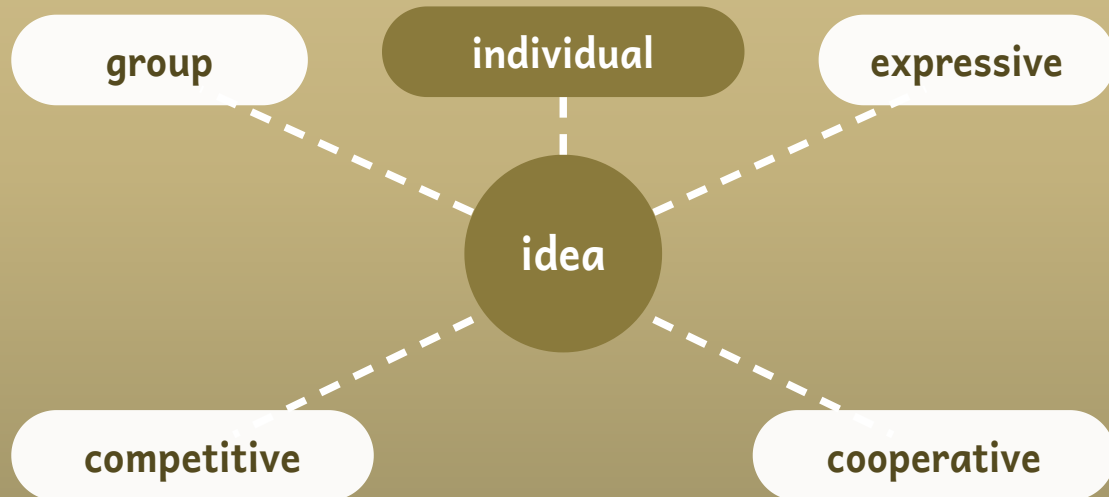
► Learn

A **creative movement** is one you chose, not one you were shown. Year 3 asked you to find it. Year 4 asks you to **use it in five contexts**, because an idea that only works when you are alone is only half an idea.

CONTEXT	WHAT YOU ACTUALLY DO
individual	you move alone; the idea is yours and a watcher can still name it
group	four of you share the idea, at the same time or one after another
expressive	the idea is used to show a feeling, not to score
competitive	the idea is used to beat a target you set: a count, a distance, a still finish
cooperative	the idea helps a partner: you make a shape they can travel through, or a path they can follow

Innovation is not a wilder fall. It is a movement you can still **stop, repeat** and **hand to somebody else**. If the watcher cannot name it, it is not ready. If you cannot land it, it is not a movement yet. The test is not "is it unusual". The test is: can the same idea work in more than one row of that table.

FIELD 3.1 · ONE IDEA, FIVE KINDS OF WORK



The gold ring in the middle is the movement you invented. Each white card is a different job for the same idea. Year 4 is finished with the idea only when it has worked on more than one of those cards.

○ DO YOU REMEMBER?

From Year 3, name two honest ways to find a new movement (start from a known action, a still shape, or a word).



The same travel, two jobs. Pip is moving alone on two hands and one foot, cream vest, head up. Bramble and Tuft have made a still arch with their arms, and Sorrel is using Pip's travel to go through it. Look at Pip's empty path: nobody is crowding him, and the arch is held still.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Tuft's idea: sideways travel on two hands and one foot, then a freeze.

Individual. He crosses eight metres. Willow writes: three limbs, side-on, freeze held for three.

Group. All four travel, one after another, same idea. The join is the invention.

Expressive. They do it slowly, as if the grass were sticky. Same idea, different feeling.

Competitive. Twenty seconds. How many still finishes. Tuft counts against his first go, not against Pip.

Cooperative. Two hold a still arch. Two travel through it with the invented idea. If the arch wobbles, it is not helping yet.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Invent one travel or one still shape that was not demonstrated. Write it so a watcher can name it.

My idea:

- 2 Use the same idea in **two** contexts. Tick which two you chose.

- ☐ individual
- ☐ group
- ☐ expressive
- ☐ competitive
- ☐ cooperative

- 3 Your watcher writes which context they actually saw, and one body fact.

Context seen: _____

Body fact:

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Keep the idea. Use it in all five contexts in one lesson, two minutes each. The watcher may only tick a context if they can name the idea and the job it was doing. If they can only tick “individual”, the idea is not ready for the open field.

► STAY SAFE

Invention stops at a landing you can see. No flips, no lifting another body, no movement that ends with a fall. Keep two metres of empty grass around a travelling body. Ribbon and scarf stay below head height when other people are near. The teacher stops the class on one long whistle; everybody freezes on that sound, including the person in the middle of a phrase.

UNIT 3 – TOPIC 3.2

Three answers to the same challenge

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Four cones, one hoop, one bench or a low rope, one scarf. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Cross a ten-metre lane three times: once over a hoop, once around it, once beside it at a crawl. Same start, same finish, three paths.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan puts a bench across the grass.

Pip goes over it. He looks finished.

“That is one answer,” says Rowan. “I asked for three. Then you pick.”

The wind off the Cascais coast catches the scarf on the bench and it will not stay. Pip’s over is suddenly not the only problem.

► Learn

A **course of action** is a whole answer: the path, the body, and the timing.

Year 3 discovered more than one way. Year 4 **investigates, designs** and then **selects**. Three answers, written before the best one is chosen, or you have only explored. The challenge can be a movement problem (a bench in the way) or an **environmental** one: wet Estoril grass at 09:00, a smaller space, a person already on your line, a scarf that will not hang still.

Three families of answer, and you need one of each before you choose:

FAMILY	WHAT YOU CHANGE	IT LOOKS LIKE
path	where the body goes	around, behind, a longer curve, a shorter cut
body	how the body goes	over, under, a different shape, a different leading part
timing	when the body goes	wait, then go; slow the approach; go in two parts

Selecting is the Year 4 skill. You pick the answer that still works **after** the setter changes one thing. The first idea that succeeds is not automatically the one you keep.

FIELD 3.2 · SAME START, SAME FINISH, THREE COURSES

start

finish

over

around

under

The two white rings never move. The box in the middle is the challenge. The three dashed lines are three courses of action. Year 4 is the unit in which you draw all three before you run any of them.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

A player who can only go one way is easy to mark. The player who can go left, go right, or stop has **three answers** to the same defender. The skill is not the first dodge. It is having the other two ready, and choosing.



Three bodies, one challenge. Sorrel is going around the hoop. Bramble is stepping over it. Tuft is travelling under the scarf that Rowan has held between two cones. Look at the white ring they all left: it is the same start, and it is empty now.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Challenge: cross eight metres. A hoop is in the middle. The grass is still wet from an Estoril morning.

Path. Pip curves around the hoop, staying on his feet, on the drier grass at the edge.

Body. Bramble goes over, two-foot jump, still land. He slips on go 2, so he keeps it as an answer but not as his choice.

Timing. Tuft waits until the setter (Rowan) lifts the scarf, then crawls under on a slow count of four.

They select Tuft's timing. Not because it looks clever. When Rowan drops the scarf two seconds earlier, the other two answers fail and his still works: he just waits longer.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write three answers to the same challenge (a hoop, a bench, or a person in the way). One path, one body, one timing.

FAMILY	MY ANSWER
path	_____
body	_____
timing	_____

- 2 Select one. Write **why**, in a sentence a watcher can check. "I liked it" is not a reason.

I chose _____ because

- 3 The setter changes one thing (smaller space, wetter grass, the hoop moved two metres). Design a new third answer. Do not reuse the one you selected.

New answer:

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Same start, same finish, thirty seconds on the timer. You must show all three families before the whistle. If the watcher can only name two, you designed two answers and hurried the third. Design is slower than exploring. That is the point.

UNIT 3 – TOPIC 3.3

Solving a task with your body

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Two hoops, one bean bag, four cones, a scarf or a ribbon, a clipboard. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

On “wide”, make a wide still shape. On “narrow”, make a narrow one. On “link”, travel from one to the other in four counts, any way you like, so long as you arrive still.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan reads a card: "Get this bean bag from this hoop to that hoop. The bag may not be carried in a hand."

Pip tucks it under his chin. It works.

"That is the given task," says Rowan. "Now write one we have not heard, and I will try it."

Pip writes do something creative Rowan does not move.

"That is not a task," says Willow. "A task is a problem with an end I can see."

► Learn

A **given task** is a problem somebody else wrote. A **self-directed task** is a problem you wrote, clearly enough that a partner can solve it without asking what you meant.

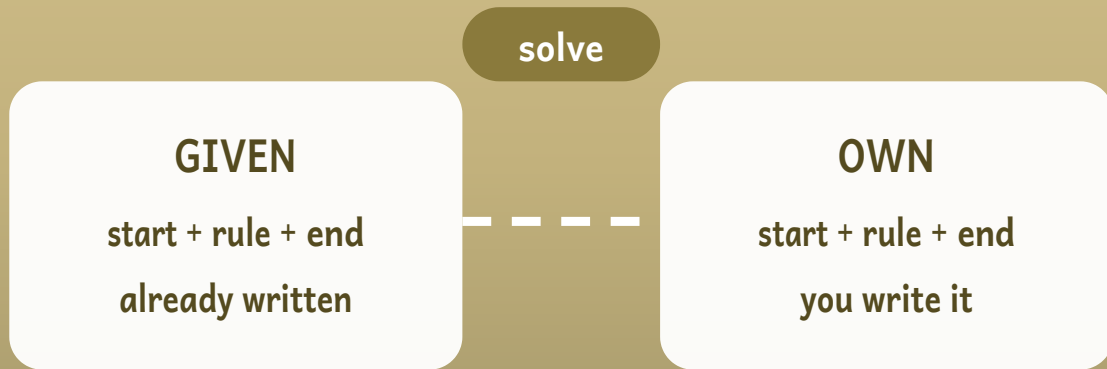
Year 3 answered short given tasks. Year 4 does both, and the second half is the harder one. A vague instruction ("be creative", "use your body") cannot be solved, because nothing would count as finishing.

The solution must be an **innovative use of movement**: not the obvious carry, not the taught throw. A gymnastic roll that takes the bag, a dance turn that leaves it, a scarf that sweeps it, a still shape a partner can pick it from: all answers. A run with the bag in a fist is not.

Write a task with three parts, or it is not finished:

- ✓ **start** : where the body (or the object) begins
- ✓ **rule** : the one thing you may not do
- ✓ **end** : what a watcher would see when it is solved

FIELD 3.3 · GIVEN TASK, THEN A TASK YOU WRITE



The left card is the task you are given. The right card is the task you write. The dashed line is the same body doing both. If the right card has no rule and no end, a partner cannot step onto that line.

○ DO YOU REMEMBER?

A task needs a start, a rule and an end. Write the three words.



The bag is not in a hand. Pip has the bean bag on the top of his head, both hands out to the side and empty. The two hoops are four metres apart. Rowan is standing at the setter's cones, watching the empty hands, which is the rule.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Given task. Bean bag from hoop A to hoop B, four metres. No hands on the bag.

Go 1. Pip uses his chin. It works. Obvious, still legal.

Go 2. Bramble balances it on his head and walks. Hands free. Willow ticks the rule.

Go 3. Sorrel sits, holds a still shape, and Tuft rolls the bag along the floor with his forehead. Two bodies, one task, no hands. Innovative, and still finished.

Own task. Tuft writes: Start in a wide shape on the hoop. Travel to the cones with only two body parts on the grass at a time. Finish still, on one foot, for a count of three.

Rowan can do that without asking a question. That is how you know the task was written.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Solve the given task (bag from hoop to hoop, no hands). Write the movement you used.
- 2 Write a self-directed task for a partner. Start, rule, end. If they have to ask what you meant, rewrite it.

Start:

Rule:

End:

- 3 Swap. Solve theirs. The watcher ticks whether the end was visible.

- ☐ I could see when it was finished
- ☐ I had to ask

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Write a task that needs two people and one piece of apparatus. You may not name the movement (“do a roll”). You may only name the start, the rule and the end. If your partner copies a taught sequence, the task was too loose. Tighten the rule until they have to invent.

UNIT 3 – TOPIC 3.4**Moving like weather****▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

Four scarves or ribbons, four cones to mark a small stage, a clipboard. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Stand still. On “rain”, make the smallest quick movement you can, eight counts. On “wind”, lean and turn, eight counts. On “sun”, the widest slow shape you can hold. Do not copy the person next to you.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The teacher says, “Show me a storm.”

All four wave their arms. It looks busy. It looks the same as last year’s storm.

Willow waits until they stop.

“That is a picture of weather,” she says. “It is not a composition. A composition has a small idea that comes back, and a mood I can name without you telling me.”

► Learn

A **compositional idea** is a plan for how movements are put together, not a list of movements.

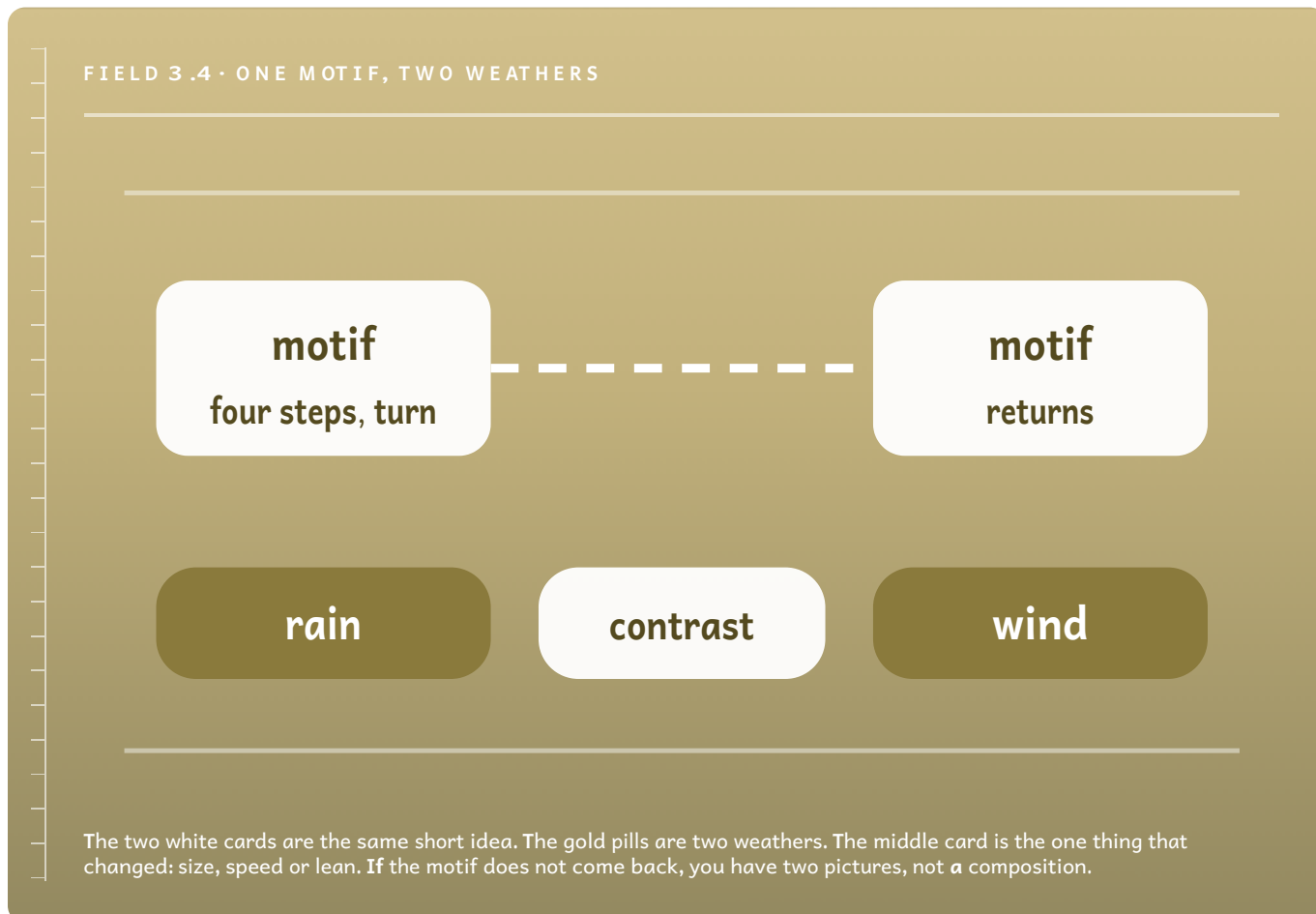
Year 3 discovered moods (storm, leaf, heavy, light). Year 4 **identifies** the idea and **demonstrates** it, so a watcher can name the theme, the mood or the emotion from the phrase alone.

Three ideas are enough for Year 4:

IDEA	WHAT THE WATCHER SEES
motif	a short movement idea that returns at least once
contrast	two opposites, side by side: small then wide, sudden then smooth, low then high
together or after	all four at the same time, or one after another

Weather is the **theme**. The feeling it gives (busy, calm, fierce, quiet) is the **mood**. What a body seems to be (careful, glad, tired) is the **emotion**. You do not act them with a face. Size, speed and level do the work.

Keep one motif. Change only one thing to change the weather. If you change everything, the watcher cannot tell it is the same idea in a different mood.



✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Traditional Portuguese folk dances such as the **vira**, from Minho, use stepping patterns that change direction and mood. The feet keep a short idea, then the same idea turns, and the feeling of the dance turns with it.

A Year 4 weather phrase works the same way. Keep a motif. Change its direction. Let the mood follow.



Weather is a phrase, not a pose. Pip, Bramble, Sorrel and Tuft are in a loose line on the grass, each holding a scarf. Pip's scarf is close to his body. Bramble's scarf is held wide. Look at their feet: all four are on the same four-step idea, not four different dances.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Motif: four steps, a turn, four steps.

Rain. Small, quick, light, scarves close. Same four-and-turn. Mood: busy.

Wind. Same four-and-turn, but each step leans as if the Cascais Atlantic were pushing. Scarves travel further. Mood: fierce.

Contrast. Rain phrase, then wind phrase, then the rain motif **returns** once, smaller than the first time. Willow names the mood (it calmed) without being told. Size and speed did the work, not a storm-face.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write your motif in one short line (body + count). Then name its first weather.

Motif:

Weather 1: _____

- 2 Change **one** thing only (size, speed, level or lean) to make a second weather. Write which thing you changed.

I changed _____ to show _____

- 3 Perform: weather 1, weather 2, motif returns. Your watcher names the mood they saw, not the weather you intended.

Mood they named:

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Two groups, one stage. Group A performs rain into wind. Group B starts eight counts later with the same motif (one after another, not at the same time). If the motif is clear, both weathers can be read at once. If it turns into waving, go back to four steps and a turn.

The open field show

Four topics, one patch of unmarked grass, and a short show another group can read without being told the plan.

Invent a movement in two contexts, design three answers and select one, solve a given task and write your own, then perform a weather phrase whose motif returns. Finished when a watcher with only the clipboard can name the idea, the choice and the mood.

THE SHOW IS GOOD WHEN	IT IS WEAK WHEN
the invented movement works in more than one context	it only works when you are alone
three answers were designed before one was chosen	you ran the first idea that succeeded
the own task has a start, a rule and an end	a partner has to ask what you meant
the motif returns and the mood can be named	it is waving, and you have to say "storm"



Four groups, one open field. Each four has a small stage of cones and a scarf. Willow is perched where she can see two groups at once. Look at the gaps between the stages: they are empty grass, so one phrase does not walk through another.

THE OPEN FIELD SHOW • THE FIVE STEPS

- 1 **Invent.** Show the movement from 3.1 in two contexts. The watcher names the idea and the jobs.
- 2 **Design three, then select.** Same start, same finish, a hoop or a bench in the way. Path, body, timing. Write the choice.
- 3 **Solve, then write.** Given task first. Then a task of your own that a partner can finish without asking.
- 4 **Weather phrase.** One motif, two weathers, the motif returns. Scarves optional.
- 5 **Be read.** Another group watches with a clipboard. If they can name the idea, the choice and the mood, the unit is done.

What good looks like: the clipboard and the show say the same thing.

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Idea: two hands and one foot, sideways. Used alone, then as a tunnel. Both readable.

Three answers: around, over, wait-then-under. They kept wait-then-under after Rowan dropped the scarf early.

Own task: wide on the hoop, two parts on the grass, still on one foot for three. Rowan did it. No questions.

Motif: four steps and a turn. Rain, wind, then rain smaller. I wrote "it calmed" before they told me the plan.

That is an open field show. It does not say whether Willow enjoyed the weather.

How did it go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet.

AT THE OPEN FIELD	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I invented a movement and used it in more than one context	☐ ☐ ☐
I designed three answers and selected one I could explain	☐ ☐ ☐
I solved a given task and wrote a task of my own	☐ ☐ ☐
I built a phrase with a motif that returned, and changed its mood	☐ ☐ ☐
A watcher could name my idea, my choice and my mood from the clipboard	☐ ☐ ☐

☐ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ I can invent a movement and use it in more than one context.
- ☐ I can design three answers to the same challenge and choose one.
- ☐ I can solve a given task, then write a task of my own.
- ☐ I can build a short phrase with a motif that returns.

☐ I can make the phrase feel like two different weathers.



UNIT 4 · TEAM ENCLOSURE

4 Taking part

At the Team Enclosure you join in after your own good bit, take a real job, set a goal you can count, lead and then follow, name a strength without ranking anyone, and wait while a plan is made.

✓ ON THIS FIELD YOU WILL

- ✓ join in alone, in a pair and in a small group, and stay in after your own go
- ✓ do every job in a team of four, then lead a short turn and follow the next person
- ✓ set a short-term goal, check it with a partner, and name a strength without ranking anyone
- ✓ wait, listen and plan together before the first pass

○ COME OUT TO THE FIELD

Last unit you invented a movement of your own. This unit you have to join a team that is already moving, and stay in it when the ball is not yours.

If you only play when you have the ball, you have not started yet.

UNIT 4 – TOPIC 4.1

Joining in properly

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One soft football, four cones, a bean bag, a baton or a rolled bib. Work in fours: mover, timer, watcher, setter.

+ WARM UP

Travel the enclosure for sixty seconds. Each time you meet someone, change path so you do not share the same two paces of grass. Freeze on a clap. If two bodies froze in the same patch, one of you was not sharing the space.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

They play a passing square, then a three-against-three.

Sorrel is excellent in the square with Pip. When the small game starts she still only looks for him.

“I’m joining in,” she says.

“You’re joining Pip,” says Willow. “Tuft and Bramble are in a different game.”

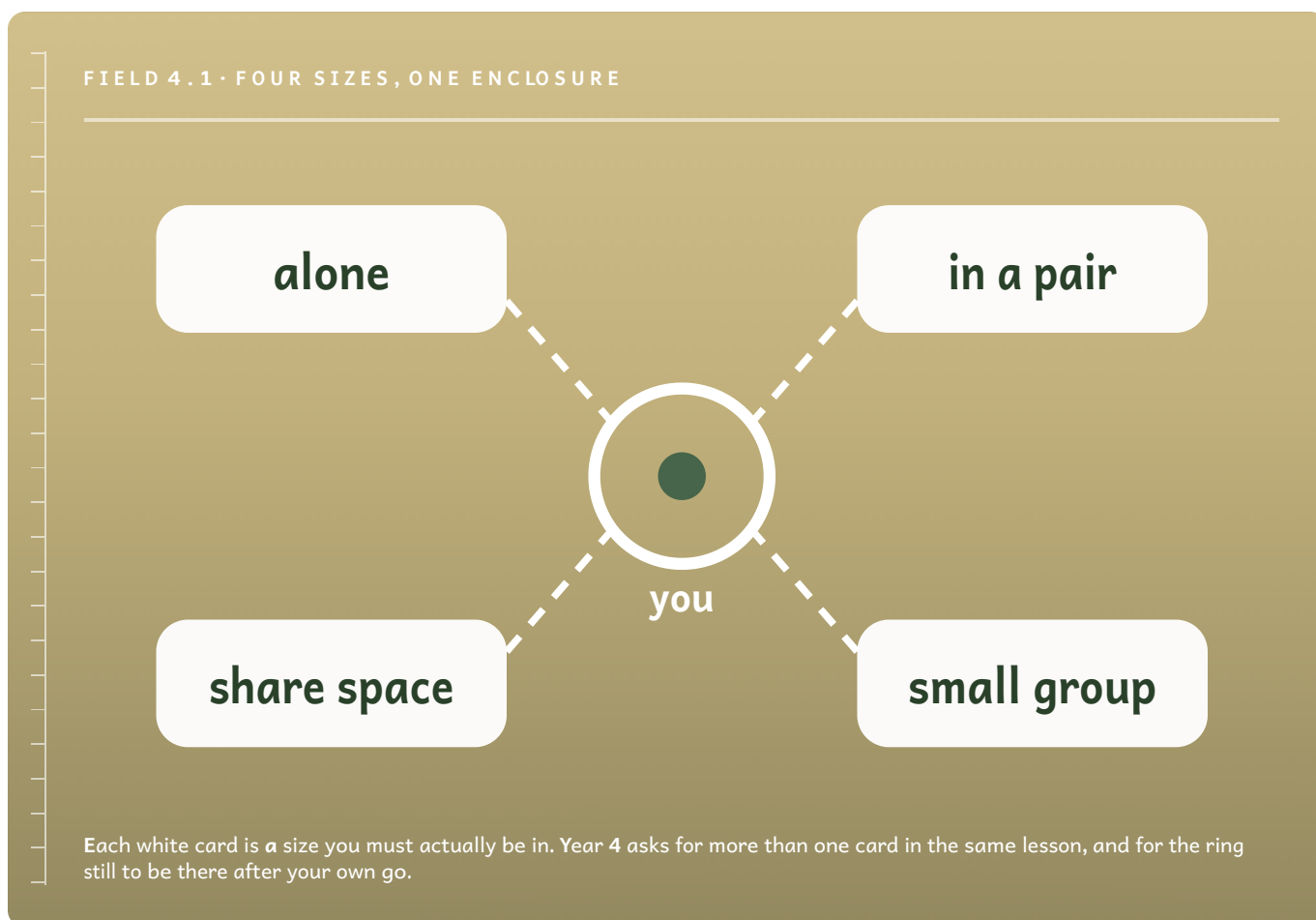
► Learn

Joining in is not arriving. It is staying, in the size of group you are actually in.

Year 3 named four homes: alone, sharing space, the whole group, playing with others. Year 4 asks you to be in **more than one size in the same lesson**, and to stay in after your own good bit.

SIZE	JOINING IN LOOKS LIKE	LEAVING LOOKS LIKE
alone	you can do the skill with nobody watching	you wait to be told
sharing space	you move around other bodies without bunching	you stand in the gap someone else needs
in a pair	you pass, receive and reset	you throw and walk off
in a small group	you have a job when you do not have the ball	you sit after you have scored, or after your relay leg

A shuttle relay is four movers and three changeovers. The runner who has finished is still in the team. Sitting down is leaving.





The leg is over. The job is not. Find Pip after the changeover: he is still in the lane, watching Tuft's start, not on the grass bank. Staying in is the picture.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Go 1. Pip runs the first relay leg well, then sits. The other three still have to run.

Go 2. He stays on his feet, but he talks only to Sorrel. Bramble, waiting for the ball, is unused.

Go 3. After his leg he resets the setter's cone, then stands where a pass can reach him. Willow ticks three sizes. That is joining in.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Run a four-leg shuttle relay. After your leg, write the next job you did. If the line is empty, you left.

After I ran I

- 2 Play two minutes of pair passing (football, handball or a bounce pass), then two minutes of three-against-three. Tick every size you were actually in.
- ☐ alone
 - ☐ sharing space
 - ☐ in a pair
 - ☐ in a small group
- 3 Name one moment you were only near the ball, not in the game.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Play the same three-against-three with a new rule: **the player who last scored may not touch the ball next**. You have to join in as a passer or a space-maker, or the team cannot finish.

UNIT 4 – TOPIC 4.2

Every job in the team

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Bibs in two colours, one basketball or a soft ball, a low hoop or a hoop the teacher holds, four cones. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Without a ball, walk to the place your job will stand. Freeze. Look around. If two people froze in the same place, one of you has the wrong job.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Mini-basketball, three against three, a low hoop.

Everybody follows the ball. The hoop is empty. Rowan has set four cones to mark a wide side. Nobody is using them. The timer has joined in as a fifth attacker.

“Who is timing?” says Willow.

Silence.

► Learn

A **job** is the work you have agreed to do for this go, not your personality and not the thing you like best.

Year 4 still rotates four jobs, and they all matter:

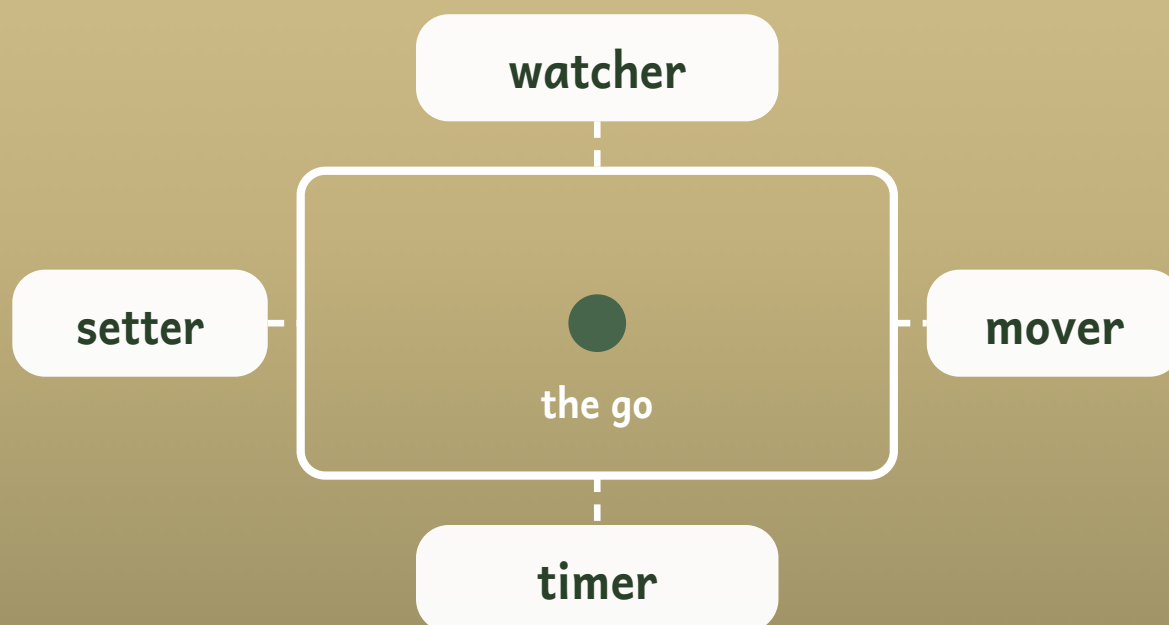
JOB	WHAT YOU ACTUALLY DO	THE TEAM FAILS WHEN
mover	takes the go	the mover also tries to time it
timer	starts and stops the count	the timer cheers instead of counting
watcher	writes one body thing	the watcher writes “good”
setter	lays the ground, then changes one thing	the setter plays the game for everybody

Year 3 named attacker, supporter, defender. Year 4 adds an **expectation**: you can point to each teammate and name their job while the ball is still moving. Keeping mover all year is keeping the ball, not doing the job.

○ DO YOU REMEMBER?

Name the four jobs you already rotate.

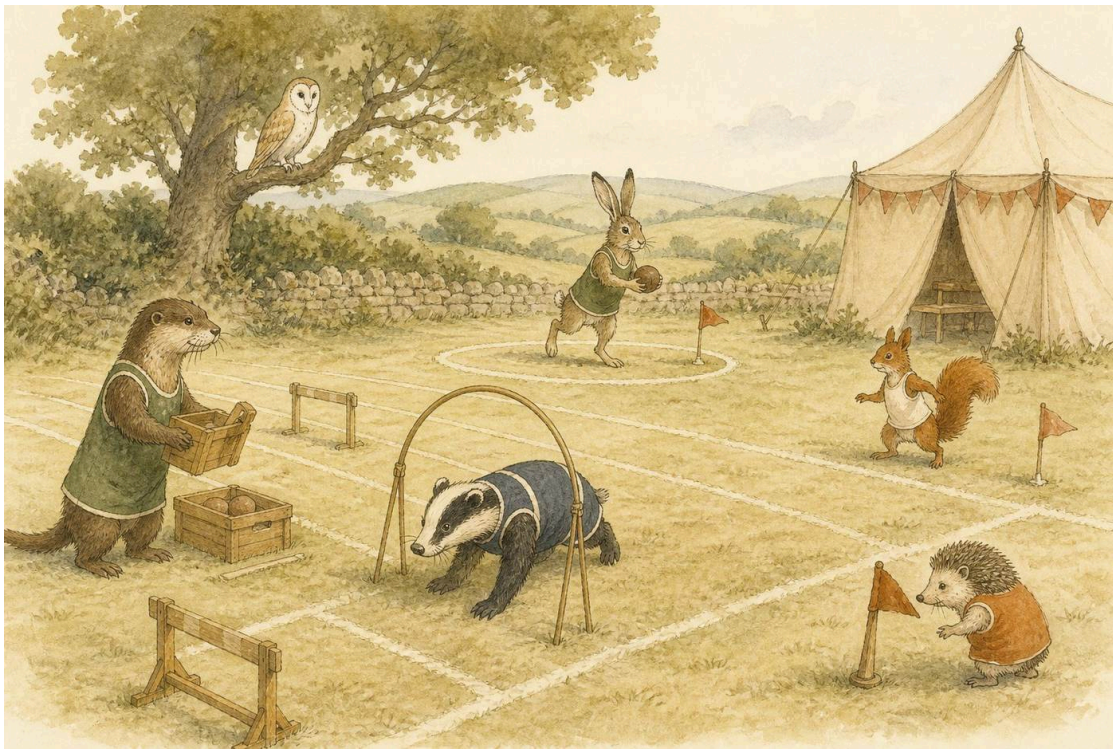
FIELD 4.2 · FOUR JOBS AROUND ONE ENCLOSURE



The four white cards are jobs, not seats of honour. If one card is empty because that person has run in to chase the ball, the go cannot be judged, timed or reset.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

The Olympic motto is Citius, Altius, Fortius—Communiter. In English: Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together. The International Olympic Committee added the fourth word on 20 July 2021. The new word is the team word. It does not say that one person should do the first three on their own.



Four jobs, one hoop. One body under the hoop, one out wide on Rowan's cone, one bringing the ball, one with the clipboard. The picture only works because they are not all in the same place.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow writes the four jobs on a card. Nobody starts until each player can point to their own name.

Go 1. All four chase the basketball. No timer. The setter's wide cone is unused.

Go 2. They freeze in their places first. Rowan, setter, pulls one cone in by two paces. The game gets smaller. The jobs stay.

Go 3. Rotate. Tuft, now mover, can still name Willow's new job while the ball is in the air. That is the expectation.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write the job you will do first, and one thing that job must do.

My job: _____ I must

- 2 Play three minutes of mini-basketball or handball. Rotate. Write the job you found hardest, and why.
- 3 Point to one teammate and say their job out loud, correctly, while the game is still going. If you cannot, you have been watching only the ball.

Their job was _____

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Play three-against-three with **silent jobs**. No talking. The only way a teammate knows you are the space-maker is that you are standing in a gap. After the game, ask them what they thought your job was.

UNIT 4 – TOPIC 4.3

The goal you set yourself

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A handball or a soft ball, a hoop or two cone-goals, a clipboard, a pencil. Work in fours, then in a pair for the check.

+ WARM UP

Ten controlled catches against a wall, counting out loud. If you drop one, the count goes back to zero. The warm-up is already a goal.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The teacher asks for a short-term goal, then walks to another group.

Pip writes be better. Rowan writes beat Sorrel Willow writes four handball passes that arrive above the waist, this lesson

Only one of those is a goal.

► Learn

A **short-term goal** is this lesson, or this week. It names a body part or a count. A watcher can check it without liking you.

Year 3 asked you to work at a target without being chased. Year 4 adds **collaboration**: you write the goal yourself, and a partner checks the tally with you. Independence is starting. Collaboration is the check. You need both.

A YEAR 4 GOAL	NOT A GOAL
four bounce passes to a moving partner, chest height	get better at basketball
land still for three counts, five of six	try harder
three passes before a shot, in our three-against-three	beat the person next to you

You may not set a goal that ranks you against a classmate.

FIELD 4.3 · YOUR GOAL FIRST, THE CHECK SECOND

MY GOAL (written first, by me)
one body thing, or a count, this lesson

OUR CHECK (counted together)

The top box is yours, written while everybody is still standing still. The bottom box is the only number **a** partner helps you count. If the top box says **a** classmate's name, it is not **a** goal.



The tally is the lesson. Willow's clipboard has one line at the top, written before the first pass. Bramble is counting with her, not instead of her.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow's goal: four handball passes that arrive above the waist, this lesson.
Partner: Bramble.

GO	ABOVE THE WAIST	PARTNER AGREES
1	no	yes, it was low
3	yes	yes
5	yes	yes

Three of five. The goal held her when the teacher was with another group. Pip's be better could not be checked. Rowan's line ranked Sorrel, so it was crossed out.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write one short-term goal for the next five minutes. It must name a body part or a count, and it must not name a classmate.

Goal:

- 2 Five goes. You count. Your partner counts. The two columns should match.

GO	I COUNTED	PARTNER COUNTED
1	_____	_____
3	_____	_____
5	_____	_____

- 3 Swap. Check their goal the same way. Tick how the work was held.

- ☐ I started without being chased
- ☐ a partner checked the tally with me

- ☐ I wandered when nobody was looking

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Set a goal that uses a teammate on purpose: a pass to a moving partner, a relay changeover that stays in the zone, a bounce pass that they can catch on the run. A goal that only works if everybody else stands still is not yet a Year 4 goal.

UNIT 4 – TOPIC 4.4

Leading, then following

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A group of four, one ball, four cones, two minutes on the clock. Everybody will lead. Everybody will follow.

+ WARM UP

The current leader walks a pathway. The other three follow two steps behind, matching speed. On the clap, the back person becomes the leader. The old leader matches the new speed.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Rowan leads the warm-up, shows a bounce pass once, gives out the four jobs, and says, "Hands were ready, Pip." Then she keeps talking. Tuft's two minutes start.

"She's still leading," says Tuft.

"Then you are not following," says Willow.

► Learn

Leading, at Year 4, is a short job you hand on. **Following** is the second half of the same skill.

Year 3 asked you to say the goal, show once, start the group, and give the lead away. Year 4 keeps those four, and adds two more: lead a warm-up, and **encourage with a judge's sentence**, not with "well done". Then you follow the next person exactly.

A Year 4 leader, in two minutes: lead the warm-up, demonstrate **once**, organise the four jobs, encourage with a body word and a count, hand the lead on, then follow. If you lead well and then wander, you have only done half the topic.

FIELD 4 .4 · LEAD, HAND ON, FOLLOW

lead

hand on

follow

The dashed line comes back. Leading that does not return to following is just keeping the ball. The accent mark is where the old leader joins the back and matches the new speed.



The bib is changing hands. Rowan is giving it to Tuft. Her other paw is empty, and she is already stepping into the line behind Bramble.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Go 1. Rowan keeps the bib. The other three get practised at waiting, and no better at deciding.

Go 2. She leads a skip warm-up, shows one bounce pass, gives out the four jobs, says “chest height, four of six”, and hands the bib to Tuft on the clap.

Go 3. Tuft leads a slower side-step. Rowan matches his speed. That is the follow.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Each person leads for two minutes. Write the one-sentence goal you gave, and the judge’s sentence you used to encourage.

My goal as leader:

I said:

- 2 After your turn, tick what you actually did.
- ☐ I led the warm-up
 - ☐ I demonstrated once
 - ☐ I organised the four jobs
 - ☐ I encouraged with a body word, then followed
- 3 As a follower, write one useful thing your leader did, and one thing that wasted time.
-

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Lead a group that includes one person who was not listening at the start. Get them in without stopping the others. Shouting their name is the weak answer. Standing where they can copy you is the stronger one.

► STAY SAFE

A leader may not invent a lift, a dive or a sprint at a wall. If you are not sure the task is safe, ask the teacher before you start the group.

UNIT 4 – TOPIC 4.5

What you are good at, and what is next

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Clipboard, pencil, a ball or a bean bag, a partner who will tell the truth. Work in pairs, then bring it back to the four.

+ WARM UP

Perform one thing you already know you do well. Then perform one thing you usually avoid. Notice how the second one feels in your hands and your feet. Do not name a winner.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

"Who is best?" says Pip.

"That is not the question," says Willow. She has three columns, not a line of names.

Pip writes quick Tuft writes careful Neither line has a classmate in it.

► Learn

A **strength** is a movement quality a watcher has seen, not a hope. An **area for improvement** is smaller than the strength, and it can be practised this week.

Potential is the next thing the body is nearly ready for. It is not a prize and it is not a rank. If Tuft's land is wobbly but his take-off is strong, the potential is a still land this week, not a story about what he will be when he is older.

Year 3 asked you to name one of your own. Year 4 asks you to name **one of your own and one of a teammate's**, and to use both to refine the next go. You never line the class up from best to worst.

NAMED STRENGTH	NAMED NEXT STEP	POTENTIAL (NEARLY READY)
I land still	I need a stronger take-off	a longer jump that still lands still
I find space	I need to pass earlier	a pass into the gap on the second touch

FIELD 4.5 · THREE COLUMNS, NOBODY RANKED

strength
already seen

next
this week

potential
nearly ready

The three boxes belong to one body. A strength with no next step is **a** boast. A next step with no strength is **a** sulk. Potential without **a** watcher is **a** guess.



Two lists, not a ranking. Tuft has written one strength and one next step. Willow's third column says "nearly ready", and it is **a** land, not **a** medal.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow watches five bounce passes.

Pip: quick hands Next: keep them up until the ball arrives Potential: a bounce pass to a moving partner this lesson

Tuft: he reads the gap Next: let the pass go earlier. Potential: the same pass, one touch sooner.

She does not write who was better. She writes two next goes. That is the topic.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write one strength a watcher has seen in you, not one you hope is true.

Strength:

- 2 Write the next step, and the potential: the thing you are nearly ready for this week.

Next:

Potential:

- 3 Name one strength you saw in a teammate, and one next step. If they cannot see the strength, it is not yet a strength.

Teammate: _____ I saw:

Their next:

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Use the next step on the very next go, in a modified football pass, a handball catch or a basketball bounce pass. If the clipboard changes and the movement does not, you have only written.

UNIT 4 – TOPIC 4.6

Patience is part of the skill

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One soft ball, six cones, four bibs. Three against three or four against four. Football, handball or basketball rules: your teacher names them before you start.

+ WARM UP

In pairs, A says a three-word instruction (go left now). B does not move until the third word is finished. Swap. If B starts on word two, the go does not count.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

They have a ball. They start.

After a minute they have not completed a pass. Rowan shouts a plan while she is running. Nobody hears it.

Willow sits them. Twenty seconds. One sentence. Then they play.

► Learn

Patience is not standing still forever. It is waiting until the plan has a sentence, then moving on that sentence.

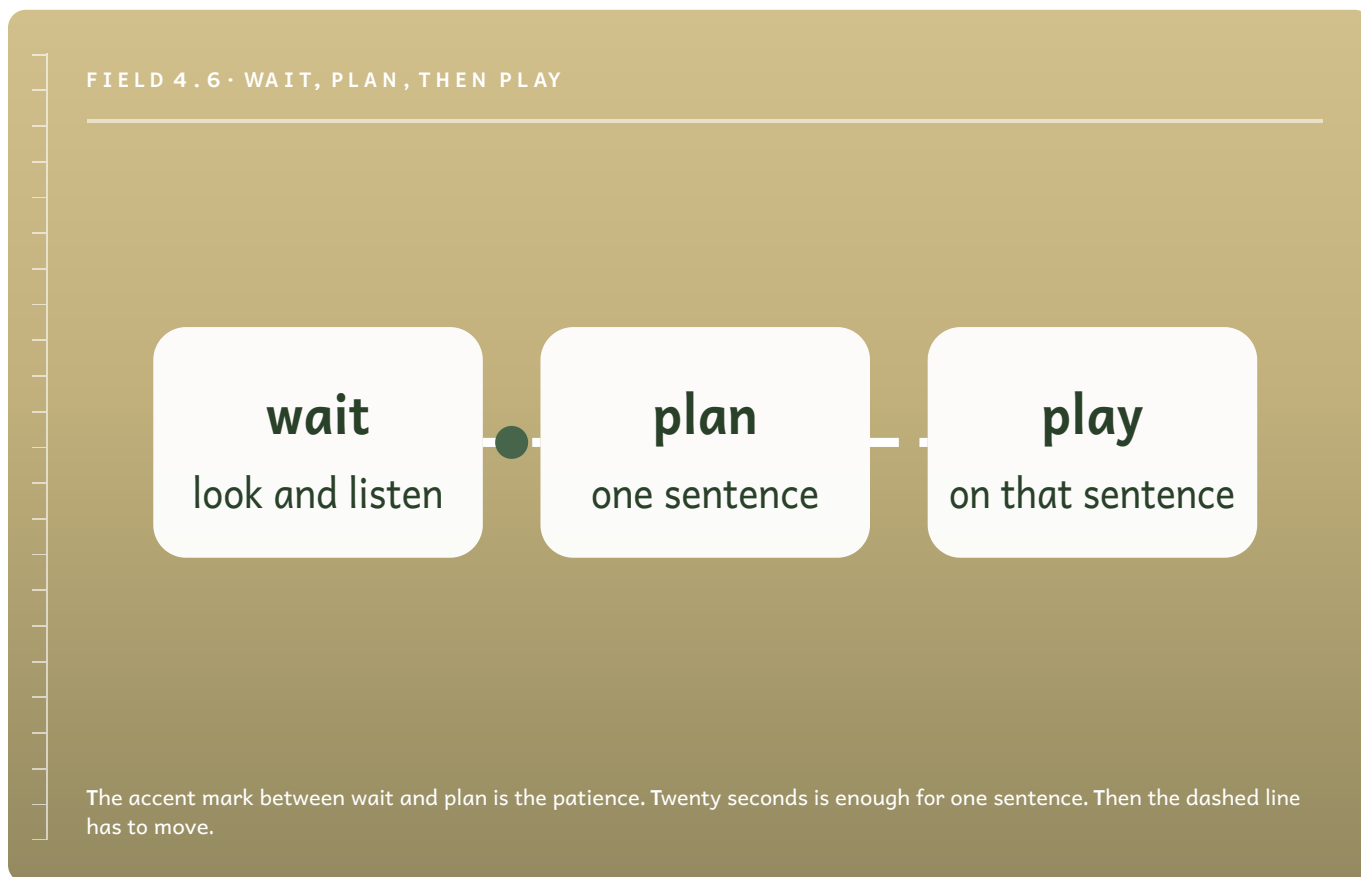
Care is how you wait: you look at the speaker, you do not bounce the ball against their shin, you do not start the game early.

Year 3 taught you to listen, then move. Year 4 asks you to **listen and plan together** before the first pass. If you play first, the talk is only noise.

A Year 4 plan, made in twenty seconds, has three parts:

PART	ONE EXAMPLE
the rule	three passes before a shot
the tactic	create space; pass into the gap
who starts	Pip restarts, then Rowan organises the next one

Useful calls stay short: time, square, turn, keep





The ball is still on the grass. Four heads are in, not four bodies chasing. The first pass has not happened yet. That is the skill, not a delay.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Rule: three passes before anyone may shoot. Tactic: create space.

Go 1. They start on the whistle with no sentence. All four chase the football. One pass. The other team take it.

Go 2. Twenty seconds. Rowan says, “Pip restarts. We pass into the gap.” They wait until she has finished. Three passes.

Go 3. The setter shrinks the enclosure by two paces. Same twenty seconds, same sentence. The movement got smaller. The patience did not.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write the one-sentence plan your four will use, before anyone moves.

- 2 Play five minutes. After each stoppage, the watcher writes whether you waited for a sentence, or started on noise.

MINUTE	WAITED?	SENTENCE WE USED
1	_____	_____
3	_____	_____
5	_____	_____

- 3 Play three more minutes. You may speak during play, but only one word.

The word that worked: _____

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Play a whole point with no calls at all. Communication has to be where you stand, from the plan you made in the twenty seconds. After the point, say whether the silence made the supporting easier or harder.

► STAY SAFE

Small sided, no sliding, no tackling from behind. If you cannot see the person you are running towards, you do not run there. Everybody stops on one long whistle, including the person with the ball.

The enclosure match

Your teacher names the rules: modified football, handball or basketball. The enclosure stays small. The four jobs rotate. Nobody is ranked.

THE MATCH IS GOOD WHEN	IT IS WEAK WHEN
every player can name their job, and one other person's	three people are chasing the ball
each player has a short-term goal they can count	the talk is only about who scored

THE MATCH IS GOOD WHEN	IT IS WEAK WHEN
the lead has changed at least once, and the old leader followed	one person is still organising at the end
a strength and a next step are named, not a rank	the clipboard says “best”
the first pass waits for a sentence	they started on noise



One enclosure, four jobs, a ball still being shared. The cones make a small pitch. Somebody is in a gap. Somebody has the clipboard. The old leader is in the line, not still holding the bib. That is the match.

THE ENCLOSURE MATCH • THE FIVE STEPS

- 1 **Join in.** One minute alone, one minute in a pair, two minutes in a four. Stay in after your own go.
- 2 **Name the jobs.** Mover, timer, watcher, setter. Everybody can point to everybody before the first pass.
- 3 **Write a short-term goal.** A body part or a count. A partner checks it at the end. No classmate's name on the line.
- 4 **Lead one restart, then follow.** Warm-up or restart, demonstrate once, organise, encourage, hand on. Then match the next leader.

- 5 **Plan, then play.** Twenty seconds, one sentence. After the match, name a teammate's strength and your own next step. No ranks.

What good looks like: the jobs, the goal, the lead and the plan can all be read off the clipboard, and they match the game.

* **WILLOW'S OWN NOTES**

Sorrel stayed in after her relay leg, then only passed to Pip. Second go she found Bramble in the gap. Jobs: Pip mover, Bramble timer, Tuft watcher, Rowan setter.

Goal: four passes above the waist. Three of five. Rowan led the restart, then followed Tuft. Nobody was named best.

Twenty seconds. One sentence. Twice they started on noise. Once they waited.

That is an enclosure match. It does not say who won.

How did it go?

Colour one ring in each row: green for yes, amber for nearly, red for not yet.

AT THE TEAM ENCLOSURE	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I joined in alone, in a pair and in a small group, and I stayed in after my own go	☐ ☐ ☐
I did a job in the team of four and I could name someone else's	☐ ☐ ☐
I set a short-term goal and a partner checked it with me	☐ ☐ ☐
I led a short turn and then followed the next person	☐ ☐ ☐
I named a strength of my own and of a teammate, and a next step, with no ranks	☐ ☐ ☐
I waited, listened and used a one-sentence plan before the first pass	☐ ☐ ☐

☐ **LOOK WHAT I CAN DO**

- ☐ I can join in alone, in a pair and in a small group, and stay in after my own go.

- ☐ I can name the four jobs and do each one.
- ☐ I can set a short-term goal and check it with a partner.
- ☐ I can lead a warm-up or a restart, then follow the next leader.
- ☐ I can name a strength and a next step, for me and for a teammate, without ranking anyone.
- ☐ I can wait, listen and plan together before the first pass.



UNIT 5 • KIT MARQUEE

5 Taking responsibility

At the Kit marquee the equipment belongs to the whole class. You share it, settle a disagreement without waiting for an adult, keep a rule even when it costs you a point, ask for help at the right moment, and give feedback a person can actually use.

✓ ON THIS FIELD YOU WILL

- ✓ share space and equipment so two groups can work at once
- ✓ settle a kit disagreement with a rule, not with volume
- ✓ keep a fair-play rule when it costs you
- ✓ ask for help with a body word, at the right moment
- ✓ give one piece of feedback a partner can change on the next go

○ COME OUT TO THE FIELD

Last unit you had a job in a team. This unit the job is the kit itself. If the hoop, the bat, the cone and the ball are always in the same four hands, the rest of the class is waiting, and waiting is not Physical Education.

UNIT 5 – TOPIC 5.1

One marquee, one class

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Eight cones, four bean bags, two hoops, one soft ball, two short racquets or bats, one hockey stick (plastic, indoor). Work as a class, then in fours.

+ WARM UP

Two minutes to set the field out from a kit list on the board. Nobody starts moving until every item is in its place and every group can see its own patch of grass.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Four groups want the two hoops. Pip's group takes both. Sorrel's group stands still.

"We got here first," says Pip.

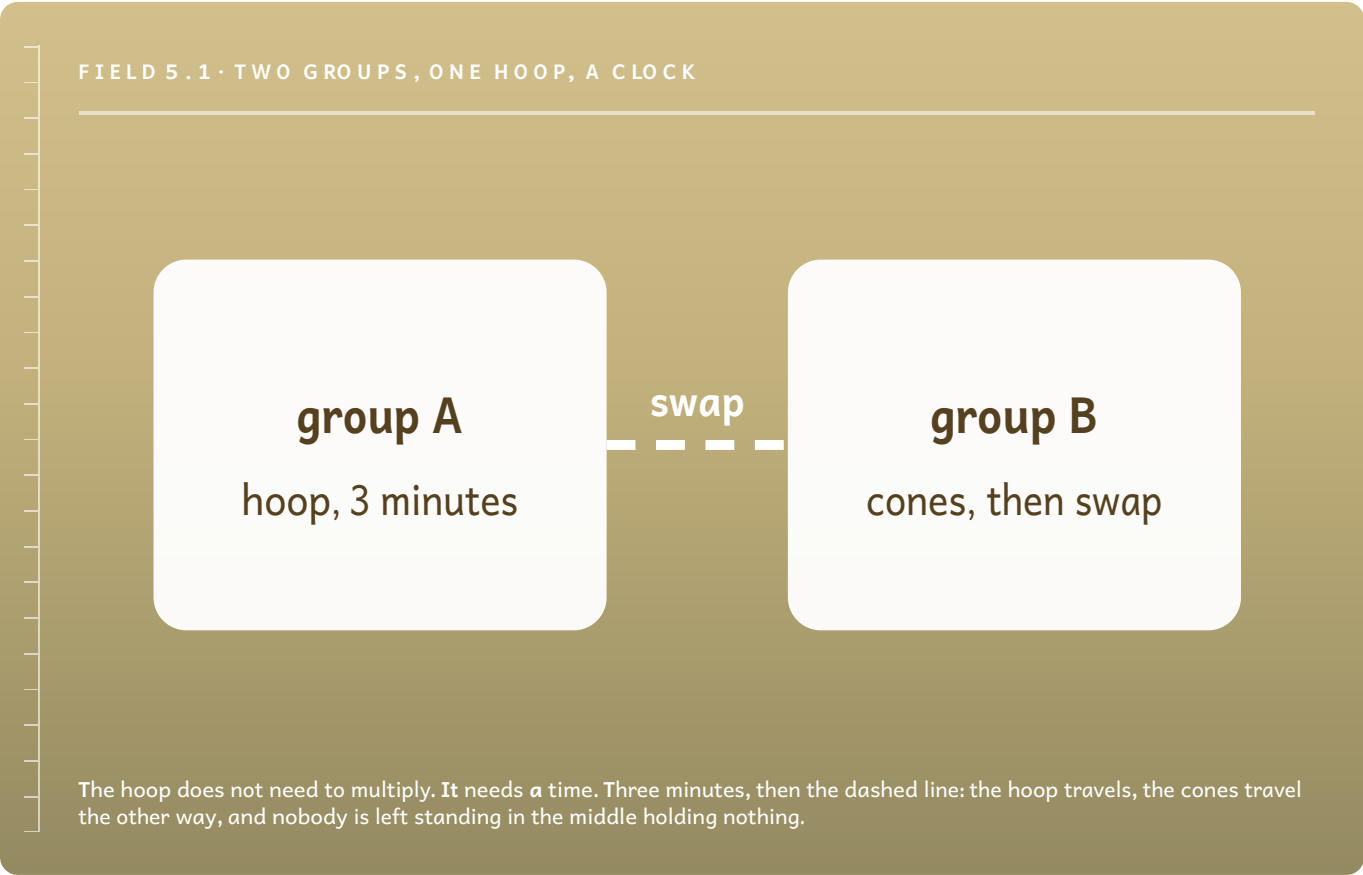
Rowan counts the class. Sixteen pupils. Two hoops. That is not a race. That is a sum.

► Learn

Sharing skilfully is not being nice. It is arranging the kit so that more than one body can work at the same time.

POOR SHARING	SKILFUL SHARING
one group has both hoops	each group has a hoop for half the time, by a clock
the bat stays in the same hands	the bat rotates with the four jobs
people queue for one ball	two smaller games, one ball each
the hockey stick swings in a crowd	a marked lane, one striker, everyone else behind the line

A racquet, a hockey stick and a bat all need **swinging space**. That space is part of the equipment. If you cannot draw a circle around the swing that nobody else enters, you do not play that station yet.



✦ DID YOU KNOW?

A tennis court is 23.77 metres long. Two players do not stand in the same half and hope. The net, the lines and the extra space behind the baseline are how they share a swinging object. Year 4 does the same thing with a plastic racquet and a painted line.



Two stations, one hoop travelling. Find the hoop in Bramble's paws, halfway between the two marked squares. Pip's group is already using cones. Sorrel's group is waiting on their own grass, not crowding the swap.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Sixteen pupils, two hoops, four racquets.

Plan 1. One queue for everything. Twelve people standing. Not sharing.

Plan 2. Rowan draws four stations: hoop, hoop, racquet target, racquet target. A three-minute sand timer. Groups rotate on the call. Everybody works, nobody swings next to a queue.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 List the kit your class has today. Draw how two groups will share the rarest item.

OUR SHARING PLAN, SEEN FROM ABOVE

- 2 Run it for six minutes. Write who waited, and for how long.

Who waited:

For: _____

- 3 Tick every one that was true.

- ☐ Two groups could work at the same time.
- ☐ A swinging object had an empty circle around it.
- ☐ The rarest item moved on a clock, not on who asked loudest.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Share one hockey stick across two groups without anyone standing still for more than twenty seconds. If you cannot, the plan is wrong, not the pupils.

► STAY SAFE

Nobody walks behind a swing. A racquet, a bat and a hockey stick are the same rule: the striker faces the field, everyone else stands where they can see the implement, and the swing stops if a person enters the circle.

UNIT 5 – TOPIC 5.2

Settling it without an adult

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One ball, four cones, a sand timer. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Play catch in fours. After one minute the setter takes the ball and holds it. The group has to decide who starts the next minute **before** they ask the teacher.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip and Sorrel both want the last bean bag.

“Miss,” they both say, at the same moment.

The teacher is with another group. Thirty seconds pass. The lesson behind them continues. The bean bag does not move.

► Learn

Negotiating means settling who uses what, for how long, with a rule you can say out loud. It is not arguing until somebody gives up, and it is not fetching an adult as the first move.

Three tools, in this order:

TOOL	WHAT YOU SAY	WHEN IT IS ENOUGH
the clock	three minutes each	the item can be used in turns
the job	the mover has it; then it rotates	the item belongs to a role, not a person
the spare plan	we use cones until the hoop is free	you can still work

An adult is for safety, for a rule nobody can find, and for a disagreement that has already used those three tools. An adult is not a faster way to get the kit.

FIELD 5.2 · THREE TOOLS BEFORE YOU CALL

1 clock

2 job

3 spare

Try them in order. If the clock works, stop there. Calling an adult from box 1 is using the teacher as kit.



The ball is on the grass between them. Pip and Sorrel are looking at it, not at the teacher. Rowan has a sand timer in one paw. That is the clock. Nobody has raised a voice yet.

■ WATCH ME TRY

One ball, two groups.

Try 1. Both shout for the teacher. The ball sits. Failed.

Try 2. Clock: three minutes each. Pip's group first, because they have not had it yet this lesson. Sorrel's group uses a hoop for those three minutes. Both groups work.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write the rule your four will use if two of you want the same item.
- 2 The setter creates a shortage (hides one cone, or holds the ball). Settle it without an adult. Write which tool you used.

Tool: _____ What we did:

- 3 Tick if you fetched an adult. If you did, write which of the three tools you had not tried.
☐ We settled it ourselves.
☐ We fetched an adult. The tool we skipped: _____

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

The setter changes the shortage twice in five minutes. Settle both without stopping the rest of the class. If the whole field goes quiet, you used volume instead of a rule.

UNIT 5 – TOPIC 5.3

What fair play actually costs

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

One ball, six cones, four bibs. Small sided game, no contact.

+ WARM UP

Two minutes of passing. If the ball goes out, the other team restart. Practise saying “yours” before you feel annoyed.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Tuft's shot would have gone in. He was over the line when he kicked it.

Willow saw. Nobody else did.

Tuft picks up the ball for a restart against himself. Pip stares.

“It still counts,” says Pip. “Nobody blew.”

“I was over,” says Tuft.

► Learn

Fair play is keeping a rule when it costs you a point, a turn, or the ball. It is easy when you are winning. The cost is the lesson.

Year 4 costs look like this:

- ✓ telling the true score when the watcher missed a miss
- ✓ giving the ball back when it touched you last
- ✓ waiting your turn when you could have taken the kit
- ✓ playing the restart the rule says, not the one that helps you

A game without that cost is just practising being lucky.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

The Olympic creed, written by Pierre de Coubertin, says the important thing is not the triumph but the fight, and not to have won but to have fought well. Fought well includes telling the truth about a line you crossed. A medal does not.



Tuft is walking the ball back. Look at his face: it is ordinary, not heroic. The cone line is under his back foot. Pip has stopped, surprised. Fair play often looks like a small, slightly annoying decision.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Rule: both feet behind the line to score.

Go 1. Sorrel scores with one foot over. She keeps the point. Pip cheers. Willow writes not fair play.

Go 2. Same shot, same foot. Sorrel says “over” and gives the ball back. The score is lower. The criterion is met.

● YOUR TURN

1 Name one rule in today's game that can cost you a point if you keep it.

2 Play five minutes. The watcher tallies honest restarts.

Honest costs we paid: _____

3 Write one moment you could have kept a point you had not earned. What did you do?

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Play with no teacher referee. The two teams referee each other. If a disagreement lasts more than ten seconds, the restart goes against both: the ball is dead, and you begin again. Speed of honesty is part of the skill.

UNIT 5 – TOPIC 5.4

Asking at the right moment**▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

Clipboard, a low hurdle, a bean bag. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Practise a sequence of three movements. Freeze if you are stuck. Do not talk yet.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip is stuck on the land. He shouts “I cannot do it” across the field, in the middle of Bramble’s go.

Bramble lands, wobbles, puts a foot down.

Two problems: Pip did not get help, and he took Bramble’s balance with him.

► Learn

Help-seeking is a skill with timing in it. The words matter, and the moment matters more.

TOO EARLY	THE RIGHT MOMENT	TOO LATE
before you have tried the one thing	after two honest goes, between goes	after you have practised the wrong thing twenty times
while somebody else is in the air	when the field is still	after you are upset

A useful ask names a **body part** and a **job**:

- ✓ “Watcher, were my hands up before the bag left?”
- ✓ “Setter, can the hoop be one pace closer?”
- ✓ “Teacher, my ankle hurts when I land.”

“I cannot” is a feeling. It does not tell anyone what to change.

Pain, fear, and broken kit go to the teacher **at once**. Those are not timing puzzles.

FIELD 5.4 · ASK BETWEEN GOES, NOT DURING ONE

GO (quiet)

GAP (ask here)

The white box on the left is **a** movement in progress. Nobody speaks into it. The box on the right is the gap. That is when **a** watcher can answer, and when **a** mover can ask.



Pip is waiting with one paw slightly up. Bramble has landed and is still. Willow has turned her head. The ask has not started yet, which is why it will work.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write one useful ask for a skill you find hard. Name a body part.
- 2 Two goes without asking. On the gap after go 2, ask. Write what you asked and what changed.

Asked:

Changed:

- 3 Tick the right audience.

- ☐ Watcher, for what the body did.
- ☐ Setter, for the ground.
- ☐ Teacher, for pain, fear, or broken kit.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

A partner may only answer questions that name a body part. If you ask “was that good?”, they stay silent. Rebuild the question until they can answer.

UNIT 5 – TOPIC 5.5**Feedback somebody can use****▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED**

Clipboard, pencil, a bean bag, a hoop. Work in pairs, then fours.

+ WARM UP

Five throws. After each one your partner may say **one** sentence, or nothing.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

"Try harder," says Pip.

Tuft does the same throw, harder. The bag flies further left.

Willow writes: that sentence named no body part, so nothing useful changed.

► Learn

Constructive feedback is a judge's sentence about the next go. It has three parts, and it is short.

PART	EXAMPLE
what I saw	your throwing elbow dropped
what to change	keep the elbow up until the bag leaves
how we will know	I will watch the elbow on the next three

"Try harder", "that was amazing", and "you are so good at this" are not feedback. The first names no body. The other two name a person.

Respect is in the **specificness**. A vague kindness leaves the mover with nothing to do. A named elbow gives them a job.

* WILLOW'S OWN NOTES

Elbow dropped on goes 1 and 2. Go 3: elbow stayed up, bag flew straighter, still missed left. Next change is the feet, not the arm.

That is respect. It takes the person seriously enough to be exact.



Willow is pointing at an elbow, not at a person. Tuft is looking at his own arm. The bag is on the grass, unused for a moment. Feedback happens in the gap, with one thing named.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Watch five goes. Write one piece of feedback with all three parts.

Saw:

Change:

How we will know:

- 2 The mover uses it for three more goes. Did the named thing change?

- ☐ yes
- ☐ nearly
- ☐ not yet

- 3 Swap. You may not use good, bad, nice, amazing, or try harder.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Give feedback to a person who is better at the skill than you are. The sentence still has to name a body part. If you cannot find one, you were not watching.

The marquee shift

Five topics, one pile of kit, and a class that can keep working when the teacher is with somebody else.

You will share the rarest item on a clock, settle a shortage with a rule, pay a fair-play cost, ask in the gap, and give feedback that names a body part. The work is finished when the kit has moved and the lesson has not stopped.

THE SHIFT IS GOOD WHEN	IT IS WEAK WHEN
two groups work at once	one queue owns the field
a disagreement used the clock or the job	the first word was the teacher’s name
a point was given back on purpose	the true score was hidden
an ask named a body part, between goes	someone shouted during a land
feedback changed the next go	the sentence was “try harder”



The marquee is open and the kit is in motion. A hoop is travelling between stations. A racquet is on the grass, not in a swing. Four clipboards are being used. Nobody is standing in a long line holding nothing.

THE MARQUEE SHIFT • THE FIVE STEPS

- 1 **Share the rarest item.** Draw the plan. Run it for six minutes.
- 2 **Make a shortage.** Settle it with the clock, the job, or a spare plan. No adult unless it is safety.
- 3 **Play a short game.** Pay one honest cost: a line, a touch, a restart.
- 4 **Ask once, in a gap.** Name a body part.
- 5 **Give one piece of usable feedback.** Saw, change, how we will know.

How did it go?

AT THE KIT MARQUEE	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
--------------------	------------------------

Two groups could work at the same time

☐ ☐ ☐

AT THE KIT MARQUEE	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
We settled a shortage without an adult	☐ ☐ ☐
I kept a rule when it cost me	☐ ☐ ☐
I asked for help in a gap, with a body word	☐ ☐ ☐
My feedback named one thing to change	☐ ☐ ☐

☐ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ I can share equipment so more than one group works.
- ☐ I can settle a kit disagreement with a clock, a job, or a spare plan.
- ☐ I can keep a fair-play rule when it costs a point.
- ☐ I can ask for help at the right moment, naming a body part.
- ☐ I can give feedback a partner can use on the next go.



UNIT 6 • FINISH FIELD

6 Healthy bodies

At the Finish field you find out why a body needs to move at all, which joints and muscles are doing the work, how hard is hard enough, how to read a risk before you go, what a warm-up is for, and what a moving body eats and drinks.

✓ ON THIS FIELD YOU WILL

- ✓ explain why regular movement matters, in your own words
- ✓ name joints, muscles and four parts of fitness in a real activity
- ✓ compare two intensities and choose one on purpose
- ✓ spot a risk and change one thing before you start
- ✓ lead a short warm-up and a short cool-down
- ✓ build a simple moving-day plate from ordinary food

○ COME OUT TO THE FIELD

A sports day ends at a finish. This field is that finish, and it is also the reason the rest of the year was worth doing. A body that only moves on lesson days is a body that forgets.

UNIT 6 – TOPIC 6.1

Why a body needs this at all

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A stopwatch, a clipboard, space to travel. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Walk two minutes, jog one minute, walk one minute. Notice what changed in your breathing. Do not judge it. Name it.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

“Why do we have to run?” says Pip. “I already know how.”

Willow does not answer with a speech. She asks him to sit still for two minutes, then stand and skip for two minutes, and say which one his body preferred afterwards.

Pip prefers the skip. He is annoyed about that.

► Learn

Your body is built to move. Regular movement helps you sleep, helps you concentrate, keeps joints moving freely, and is one of the ways people look after how they feel. It is not a punishment and it is not a prize.

Year 4 does not need adult training plans. It needs a habit: most days, your body works hard enough to raise your breathing for a while, and some days it also pulls, pushes, hangs or jumps.

KIND OF DAY	WHAT “MOVING” CAN LOOK LIKE
most days	games, walking to school, skipping, cycling, swimming, PE
at least three days	climbing, jumping, hanging from a bar, pushing against the floor
rest	sleep, quiet play, stretching that does not hurt

You are not trying to win at health. You are trying to keep the range you built in Unit 1.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

WHO says children and young people aged 5 to 17 should do **at least an average of 60 minutes** of moderate-to-vigorous physical activity a day across the week, mostly the kind that raises breathing. More than 60 minutes brings extra benefit. Activities that strengthen muscle and bone should appear on **at least three days**. An hour can be in pieces: a game, a walk, a PE lesson. It does not have to be a single block.



Not a race. A habit. Bramble is jogging beside the painted lane, upright, talking to Tuft who is walking. Willow is on a post. Nobody is collapsing and nobody is posing. This is what most of the sixty minutes looks like.

■ WATCH ME TRY

Willow times two minutes of sitting, then two minutes of skipping.

Pip's breathing is quiet after sitting and bigger after skipping. He can still talk after the skip, in short sentences. That is **moderate**. If he could only gasp, it would be vigorous, and two minutes of that is enough for a start.

● YOUR TURN

1 List three ways you already move in a normal school day, outside this lesson.

2

3

4

5 For each one, tick whether it raised your breathing.

- ☐ 1 raised it
- ☐ 2 raised it
- ☐ 3 raised it
- 3 Write one extra ten-minute burst you could add this week (a game at break, stairs, a walk in Cascais after school).

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Build a sixty-minute picture of your week in pieces, not one heroic run. If the picture only has PE lessons, it is not a week yet.

UNIT 6 – TOPIC 6.2

Joints, muscles and the parts of fitness

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

A mat, a low hurdle, a bean bag. Work in fours.

+ WARM UP

Slowly bend and straighten: ankles, knees, hips, shoulders, elbows. Name each joint as you move it. If a name is missing, your watcher supplies it.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

“My legs hurt,” says Sorrel after a sprint.

“Which bit?” says Willow.

Sorrel points at everything from hip to ankle.

That is not a map. That is a continent.

► Learn

A **joint** is where two bones meet and movement happens: ankle, knee, hip, shoulder, elbow, wrist, spine. A **muscle** pulls across a joint to make the movement. You do not need a medical chart. You need to name the ones you are using.

Four parts of fitness you can feel in Year 4:

PART	WHAT IT FEELS LIKE	A YEAR 4 EXAMPLE
stamina	you can keep going	jogging a lap without stopping
speed	you can go fast for a short time	a sprint to a cone
strength	you can push, pull or hold	a still shape, a hang, a push-up from the knees
flexibility	a joint moves through its range without pain	reaching to a cone, a controlled stretch

Agility (change of direction) and balance sit on top of those four. You already practised them in Unit 1.

FIELD 6.2 · NAME THE JOINT THAT IS WORKING

sprint
speed

hang
strength

reach
flexibility

jog
stamina

Four stations, four parts of fitness. At each one you name one joint that is doing the work. "Legs" is not a joint.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

A school-aged child’s **resting** heart rate is often somewhere around 70 to 120 beats per minute. It varies from child to child, and a single number is not a test you can fail. After running it is faster. That is the heart doing its job. If you ever feel dizzy, faint, or have pain in the chest, you stop and tell a teacher. You are not diagnosing anything with a count.



Tuft is naming a knee, not a whole leg. He is in a controlled squat, looking down at the joint. Willow has written “knee” on the clipboard. The hurdle behind them is for the next station, speed, not for this one.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Visit four stations (sprint, hang or hold, reach, jog). Write the part of fitness and one joint.

STATION	PART OF FITNESS	JOINT I USED
1	_____	_____
2	_____	_____

STATION	PART OF FITNESS	JOINT I USED
3	_____	_____
4	_____	_____

- 2 Count your pulse for fifteen seconds after the jog, then at rest after two minutes of sitting. Write both counts. They should not be the same.

After the jog: _____ After sitting: _____

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Invent a fifth station that trains two parts of fitness at once (a jump and a land is speed and balance). Name both, and the joints.

► STAY SAFE

No stretching into pain. A stretch should feel like a pull, not a sting. Stops on dizziness, chest pain, or a joint that does not want to move.

UNIT 6 – TOPIC 6.3

How hard is hard enough

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Cones in a line, a stopwatch. Work in pairs.

+ WARM UP

Walk, jog, stride, walk. Same path. The only thing that changes is how hard.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Sorrel sprints every shuttle. After four she is done, and there are six left.

Tuft jogs the same shuttles. He finishes all ten, talking in short sentences.

“I went harder,” says Sorrel.

“You went faster,” says Willow. “That is not the same as lasting.”

► Learn

Intensity is how hard the body is working, not how impressive it looks.

A simple Year 4 scale:

INTENSITY	TALK TEST	WHEN TO USE IT
easy	you can talk in full sentences	warm-up, cool-down, recovery
steady	short sentences, a little out of breath	most of the sixty minutes
hard	only a few words	short sprints, a hill, a relay leg

Hard is useful in short bursts. Easy is useful on purpose, not as a way of hiding. The skill is **choosing**, then checking with the talk test, then adjusting.

FIELD 6.3 · THREE SPEEDS ON THE SAME PATH

easy



steady



hard



Same cones, three paints. Easy is a solid line you could talk on. Steady is broken. Hard is dotted and short: you do not stay on it for the whole path.



Same lane, different intensity. Sorrel is sprinting the near cones, almost bouncing. Tuft is jogging the far side, upright, mouth slightly open as if mid-sentence. Bramble has the watch. Both belong on this field.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Run the same shuttle three ways: easy, steady, hard. After each, tick the talk test.

GO	I COULD TALK IN...	INTENSITY I MEANT
1	_____	easy
2	_____	steady
3	_____	hard

- 2 Plan a five-minute block: one minute easy, three steady, one hard, then easy. Do it. Did the plan match the talk test?

- ☐ yes
- ☐ nearly
- ☐ I stayed on hard too long

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Change one thing (wind, a slight slope, a ball in your hands) and keep the same intensity. If the talk test jumps, you did not adjust.

UNIT 6 – TOPIC 6.4

Reading the risk before you go

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

The field as it is today. Clipboard. Work as a class, then in fours.

+ WARM UP

Walk the edge of the space once. Do not start the game. Look.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The hall has a wet patch by the door. The cones are already out.

Pip starts the relay anyway. He slips, puts a hand down, stands up laughing.

Rowan moves a cone. Nobody else had seen the water.

► Learn

A **risk** is something that could hurt somebody if you ignore it. **Managing** it means changing one thing **before** the movement, not after the slip.

Year 4 checks, every lesson:

- ✓ floor or field: wet, holes, glass, bags in the run-up
- ✓ kit: broken hoop, split bat, cone on its side
- ✓ space: swinging circle, wall too close, sun in the eyes
- ✓ people: jewellery, laces, a body that already hurts
- ✓ weather (outside): heat, rain, a slippery painted line

You tell a teacher about water, glass, pain, and broken kit. You can move a bag, tie a lace, and change a run-up yourselves.

✦ DID YOU KNOW?

Most slips in school sport happen on something that was already there at the start of the lesson: a bag, a wet patch, an untied lace. The check is not a mood. It is a walk.



Rowan has not started the game. He is pointing at a dark patch on the floor near the door. The cones are already out, which is how people miss it. Pip has stopped. The relay has not begun. That is the successful picture.

● YOUR TURN

1 Walk the space. Write three risks, and what you did about each.

RISK	WHAT WE CHANGED

2 Tick the ones that needed a teacher, not just a cone move.

- ☐ wet floor or glass
- ☐ pain
- ☐ broken kit

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

The setter adds one hidden risk (a bag at the edge, a cone on its side). The group must find it before go 1. If they find it after a stumble, they failed the topic even if nobody was hurt.

► STAY SAFE

Pain is information. You stop, you tell, you do not “run it off”. Heat: drink water, find shade, shorten the hard bursts. Cold: keep the warm-up longer.

UNIT 6 – TOPIC 6.5

Before, and afterwards

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Open space, no extra kit required. Work in fours. One pupil leads.

+ WARM UP

Today the warm-up is the lesson. Follow the leader for two minutes, then swap.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

The class sprints first. Two people pull up short, holding a muscle at the back of the thigh.

“We were not warm,” says Willow, which is a description, not a scolding.

► Learn

A **warm-up** raises temperature and wakes the joints you are about to use. A **cool-down** brings breathing back towards easy and finishes with slow stretches that do not hurt.

Year 4 warm-up, about five minutes:

- 1 **Easy travel** : walk, then jog, until you can talk in short sentences
- 2 **Joints** : circles and bends for the parts this lesson will use
- 3 **A rehearsal** : a slower, smaller version of the first skill

Year 4 cool-down, about three minutes:

- 1 **Easy travel** until talking is easy again
- 2 **Slow stretches** for the muscles you used, no bouncing, no pain
- 3 **Water**

You can lead this. Leading a warm-up is a Year 4 leadership job from Unit 4, used here on purpose.



Tuft is leading, not performing. The others are jogging behind him in a loose curve, not sprinting. His paws are low. This is the first box of the warm-up: easy travel, talking still possible.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Write a five-minute warm-up for Athletics Day (sprint, jump, throw).
- 2

3

4

5 Lead it for your four. The watcher ticks whether talking was still possible after part 1.

☐ easy travel: we could talk

☐ joints: we named the ones we would use

☐ rehearsal: it was a smaller version, not the full sprint

3 After the main activity, lead a three-minute cool-down. Write the stretch you chose and the muscle it was for.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Lead a warm-up for a different lesson (football, gymnastics, dance). If you use the athletics one unchanged, you have not read the joints.

UNIT 6 – TOPIC 6.6

What a moving body eats

▣ THE EQUIPMENT YOU NEED

Paper and pencil. No food in the hall unless the teacher has planned it. This is a thinking and drawing topic, then a moving one.

+ WARM UP

Easy jog, then water. Notice that the drink is part of the lesson, not a reward for it.

◆ WHAT HAPPENED

Pip wants to skip lunch so he will be “lighter” for the sprint.

Willow says no, once, clearly. A moving body needs food and water. Skipping lunch is not a tactic. It is a problem, and it goes to an adult.

► Learn

A moving body needs **ordinary food**, regularly, and **water**. Year 4 does not count calories, weigh people, or divide foods into good and bad as a moral story.

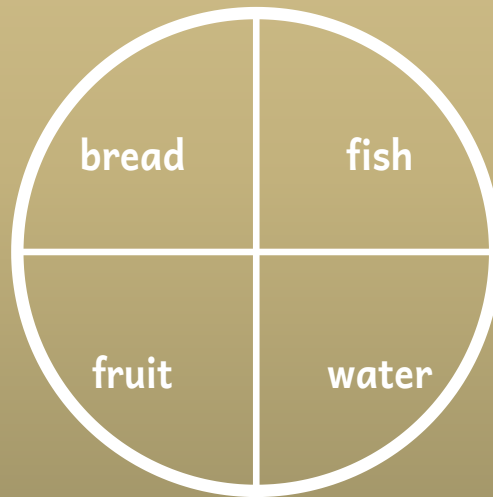
A simple moving-day plate:

ON THE PLATE	WHY A MOVER CARES
something starchy	bread, rice, potato, pasta: fuel for the next hour
some protein	fish, egg, beans, cheese, meat: repair after work
fruit or vegetables	soup, salad, an apple, a carrot
water	before you are thirsty, and after you finish

Portuguese school lunches already look like this more often than people admit: soup, fish, bread, fruit. A banana in the bag on Athletics Day is a tactic. An empty stomach is not.

Drinks: water is the default. You do not need a special sports drink for a Year 4 lesson.

FIELD 6.6 · A MOVING-DAY PLATE



Four quarters, not a perfect diet lecture. Bread, fish, fruit, water is already a moving-day plate. You can swap rice for bread, beans for fish, soup for fruit. You cannot swap nothing.



A still life, not a lecture. On a wooden bench: a small loaf, an orange, a bottle of water, a banana. No labels. No weighing scales. The field is visible behind, empty, waiting.

● YOUR TURN

- 1 Draw your moving-day plate for Athletics Day (16 December). Label the four parts.

MY PLATE, LABELLED

- 2 Write when you will drink water that day: before, during (in the gaps), after.

- 3 Tick every sentence that is true.

- ☐ I will eat something before I sprint.
- ☐ Water is my default drink.
- ☐ Skipping a meal is not a tactic.

▲ FIELD CHALLENGE

Plan the same plate for a hot June multi-sports day. What changes? Usually the water, the shade, and a fruit that travels. Not the idea of eating.

► STAY SAFE

No child is weighed, compared, or commented on for size or appetite in this lesson. If a pupil is skipping meals to “perform”, that is a teacher-and-family conversation, not a class joke.

The finish field

Six topics, one year of moving, and a body that is supposed to keep doing this after the book closes.

You will say why movement matters, name joints and parts of fitness, choose an intensity on purpose, change a risk before you start, lead a warm-up and a cool-down, and put ordinary food on a plate. The work is finished when you can do those things on Athletics Day without being reminded of each step.

THE FINISH IS GOOD WHEN	IT IS WEAK WHEN
the sixty minutes is a week, in pieces	PE is the only moving
joints are named, not “legs”	the map is a continent
intensity was chosen, then checked	everything was a sprint
a risk was moved before go 1	the check happened after a slip
someone in the four led the warm-up	you sprinted cold
the plate has fuel and water	the tactic was skipping lunch



The field at the end of the morning. The six friends are walking, not racing, towards the marquee. Water bottles are in paws. The painted lanes are empty behind them. Cool-down looks like this: ordinary, together, still moving.

THE FINISH FIELD • THE SIX STEPS

- 1 **Why.** Name three ways you already move, and one extra burst for this week.
- 2 **Map.** Four stations: stamina, speed, strength, flexibility. Name a joint at each.
- 3 **Intensity.** Easy, steady, hard on the same path. Check with the talk test.
- 4 **Risk.** Walk the space. Change three things before anyone starts.
- 5 **Warm and cool.** One pupil leads each. The watcher uses the talk test.
- 6 **Plate.** Draw it. Water goes on it.

How did this field go?

AT THE FINISH FIELD	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I can say why a body needs to move, without being told	☐ ☐ ☐
I can name joints and four parts of fitness in an activity	☐ ☐ ☐
I chose an intensity and checked it with the talk test	☐ ☐ ☐
I found and changed a risk before we started	☐ ☐ ☐
I can lead a short warm-up and a short cool-down	☐ ☐ ☐
My moving-day plate has fuel and water	☐ ☐ ☐

☐ LOOK WHAT I CAN DO

- ☐ I know that most days I need about an hour of real moving, in pieces.
- ☐ I can name ankle, knee, hip, shoulder, elbow, and four parts of fitness.
- ☐ I can choose easy, steady or hard, and check it by talking.
- ☐ I can walk a space for risks and change something before we start.
- ☐ I can lead a warm-up and a cool-down.

- ☐ I can put ordinary food and water on a moving-day plate.

How did it go?

Colour one ring for the whole year, not for your best lesson.

ON THE SPORTS DAY FIELD	YES / NEARLY / NOT YET
I can keep a broad range of movements, and name the two weakest	☐ ☐ ☐
I can describe a movement with a body part and a count	☐ ☐ ☐
I can invent a movement and a second way to solve the same task	☐ ☐ ☐
I can do a job in a team, then lead, then follow	☐ ☐ ☐
I can share kit, keep a costly rule, and give usable feedback	☐ ☐ ☐
I can choose an intensity, check a risk, warm up, and eat before I move	☐ ☐ ☐

What I want to improve next term:

Words we used

Words from the whole field. You used every one of them this year.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
range	Everything your body can do. Bigger than you think, and not all of it in the same condition.
consolidate	To move a movement from working to kept, and then keep it there.
kept	A movement you can do today, first go, without warming up to it.
working	A movement you can do, but not every time, and not without thinking about it.
family	A group of movements that do the same job: travelling, jumping, turning, balancing, throwing, catching, striking, stopping.
sequence	Four or more movements joined so that there is no stop in the middle.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
join	The place where one movement becomes the next. Three of them in a Year 4 sequence.
variety	Using movements from different families, and being able to solve the same task more than one way.
repeatable	Able to be performed twice with no difference a watcher can name.
fluency	Moving with no hesitation and no gap. Not the same as moving fast.
hesitation	A pause you did not plan. Countable, which is why the watcher counts them.
control	Ending a movement where and how you meant to, every time and not by luck.
adapt	To change small details of a movement so that it still works when the ground changes.
context	Everything around the movement: the space, the equipment, the rules and the other people.
crossing	A place where two routes want the same patch of ground at the same moment.
give way	To let somebody else through, by changing your line or your timing, on purpose and decided in advance.
structured	An activity where rules decide what happens, such as a game.
self-selected	An activity you choose and arrange yourselves.
criterion	The one thing you agreed to look at before anybody moved. Not the score.
tactic	A plan inside the rules that makes the next few seconds easier.
action	What the body did: run, jump, throw, catch, turn, balance.
dynamic	How the action was done: fast or slow, strong or light.
space	Where the action travelled: high or low, short or long.
relationship	Who or what the action was with.
motif	A short movement idea that comes back.
short-term goal	A change you can count in this lesson, not “be better”.
fair play	Keeping a rule when it costs you a point, a turn, or the ball.

WORD	WHAT IT MEANS
intensity	How hard the body is working, checked with the talk test.
stamina	Being able to keep going.
warm-up	Easy travel, then joints, then a small rehearsal, before the real work.

The four jobs

JOB	IN ONE LINE
mover	Does the movement, properly, as many times as the task asks.
timer	Counts or times, and says the real number out loud.
watcher	Looks at one thing, and says what they saw, not whether they liked it.
setter	Lays the ground out, and changes one thing while the mover is working.

Answers for units 1 to 6

Some tasks in this unit have one right answer. Most do not, because a movement task is answered with a body and no two bodies answer it the same way. Where there is no single answer, this page says what a good answer must contain instead. Teachers can mark from the right-hand column without having seen the lesson.

1.1 Keeping everything you can do

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1, the round of eight	Eight rows, one state ticked in each. Look for a mixture : a pupil who ticks kept eight times has not been honest, and a pupil who ticks new eight times has misread the task, because Years 1 to 3 taught all eight families.
Practise 2, the two weakest and the one thing to change	The one thing must be about the body , and specific: “hands up before the bag arrives”, “look at the line, not my feet”. Reject “catch better”, “be smoother” and “try harder”, which name no body part and cannot be watched.
Practise 3, the table of ten goes	Four rows completed, from goes 1, 4, 7 and 10. The watcher’s column must describe the one chosen thing each time, not the whole movement.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 4, the three stations checked again	This is the task that carries the objective. Three stations previously scored kept, done once each, with an honest yes or no. A pupil who lost one has still passed the task if they noticed and wrote why: the commonest true reason is tiredness. A pupil who did not check has not done the topic.
Practise 5, ticks	All three may be ticked. The third, “one was worse because I was tired”, is a correct and useful answer and must not be marked down.
Go a little further, scoring a partner’s round	Expect disagreement on two or three stations. The rule to teach from it: where mover and watcher disagree, the movement is working rather than kept, because a mover remembers the good goes and a watcher counts all of them.

1.2 Four movements, three joins

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, the three states	New, working, kept. All three needed, in any order.
Practise 1, four movements from four families	Four movements, each from a different family, written in performance order, with the family named. Reject two movements from one family, and reject any family used twice in a row even if the movements have different names, for example “run” and “sprint”.
Practise 2, which join differed	A named join, 1, 2 or 3, with what was different about it. Expect join 2 most often. A pupil who writes the whole sequence again instead of naming the join has not done the task.
Practise 3, two more goes	Two rows, each naming the weakest join and answering whether a watcher could tell the goes apart. Improvement means the answer moves from yes towards no.
Practise 4, ticks	All three may be true. The third, “my two performances were the same”, is the one that decides whether the sequence is kept
Field challenge	Passed only when a watcher who has not seen the sequence cannot say which of two consecutive performances was which.

1.3 Fluent, not fast

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1, three goes	Three times and three hesitation counts, with the place of the first hesitation named. Expect the count to fall while the time barely moves.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 2, which cause	Any of the three, with the pupil's own description matching it. "Looking for the next thing" pairs with a pause and a turning head; "arrived somewhere I could not leave" pairs with shuffling feet.
Practise 3, time change against hesitation change	The point of the topic. A typical honest answer is a time change of one second or less and a hesitation change of two or three. A pupil whose time fell a great deal has probably hurried, which usually shows as a hesitation count that did not fall.
Practise 4, two versions	Two different sets of four movements answering the same task, each with its own hesitation count. Both should use four families. Accept a version that is not yet fluent, provided the pupil says so in task 5.
Practise 5, ticks	The third box, "one version is not finished yet", is an honest pass, not a fail.
Go a little further, the slow version	Hesitations usually reappear. Any answer that notices this has met the objective, including one that says the slow version was worse.
Do you remember, the four dials	Speed, level, size, force. All four needed, in any order.

1.4 A field with other people on it

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Do you remember, what a hesitation is	A pause the mover did not plan. Accept any wording that contains "did not plan" or "unplanned". Not simply "a stop" and not "going slowly".
Practise 1, both routes drawn	Two routes drawn with the correct marks, the pupil's own dashed and the other group's dotted with an arrow, and the crossing ringed. Both routes must be drawn; a plan with only one route on it has missed the whole topic.
Practise 2, decided in advance	One named person changing line and a different named person changing timing . Both changing the same thing is the error the scenario is built on: reject it and send them back to decide again.
Practise 3, three goes	Three rows. The "what I read" column must name where the other group was going or when they would arrive, not what the other group is called. "Did anybody stop?" should reach no by go 3.
Practise 4, the setter's change	Two answers: what the setter moved, and the one detail the mover changed. A pupil who rebuilt the whole sequence has not adapted it. A pupil who says "nothing changed" should be asked whether they were looking.
Practise 5, ticks	All three may be true. The first is the one to insist on: deciding before moving, not while moving.

TASK	ANSWER, OR WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Field challenge	Passed when the sequence keeps four movements, three joins and nought hesitations while two other groups cross, and then again with the pupil in the crossing role. Both halves are needed.

The sports day

STEP	WHAT A FINISHED PROJECT LOOKS LIKE
1 Check what you have	A completed round of eight, with the weakest station consolidated before any sequence was built.
2 Build it	Four movements from four families, three joins, and the field drawn before anybody moved.
3 Make it flow	A hesitation count that reaches nought, or an honest record of why it did not.
4 Share the field	A crossing agreed in advance, performed with another group crossing, and one setter change absorbed on the last go.
5 Be described	A watcher's written description naming all four movements, all three joins, the hesitations and what happened at the crossing.
The comparison	The plan and the description side by side, with the differences named. Finding a difference is a pass, not a fail. A group that finds none has usually not looked.

2.1 The words a judge uses

TASK	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1	A sentence with a body part and a count. Reject good, bad, nice.
Practise 2	At least two of body, place, count ticked.
Practise 3	The rewrite fills two boxes.

2.2 Action, dynamic, space, relationship

TASK	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1	Three rows, each naming one dial, none repeating the action as the change.
Practise 2	The partner names a dial, not the action.
Do you remember	Speed, level, size, force (Year 3 dials), any order.

2.3 Judging against a criterion

TASK	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1	A criterion that names a body part, written before go 1.
Practise 2	Both columns filled. Improvement is the criterion column, not only the score.

2.4 Rules, tactics and the plan inside a game

TASK	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
Practise 1	One named rule and one named tactic (create space, use space, or move after passing).
Practise 2	At least one row that is not “none” / chasing the ball.

3.1 to 3.4 Moving creatively

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
3.1	A movement the pupil was not shown, performed in more than one context (alone and with others).
3.2	Three different answers to the same challenge, each named.
3.3	A task solved with the body, one constraint kept (for example, empty hands).
3.4	A short phrase that returns (a motif) and a named mood, not four random poses.

4.1 to 4.6 Taking part

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
4.1	Evidence of joining in alone, in a pair and in a four, and staying in after their own go.
4.2	All four jobs named, and one other person’s job.
4.3	A short-term goal with a count or a body part. Reject “be better”.
4.4	One lead and one follow in the same lesson.
4.5	One strength and one next step, no ranking word.
4.6	A one-sentence plan before the first pass.

5.1 to 5.5 Taking responsibility

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
5.1	Two groups working at once, swinging objects given an empty circle.
5.2	Clock, job or spare plan used before an adult.
5.3	One honest cost paid (a point, a turn, or the ball given back).
5.4	An ask that names a body part, spoken in a gap.
5.5	Feedback with saw / change / how we will know. Reject try harder.

6.1 to 6.6 Healthy bodies

TOPIC	WHAT A GOOD ANSWER CONTAINS
6.1	Three existing bursts of moving and one extra, not PE as the only answer.
6.2	Four parts of fitness and a named joint at each, not “legs”.
6.3	Easy, steady and hard on the same path, checked with the talk test.
6.4	Three risks named, and what was changed, before go 1.
6.5	A three-part warm-up and a named cool-down stretch.
6.6	A plate with fuel, protein or beans, fruit or vegetables, and water. Skipping a meal is not a tactic.

Sources for this book

Every fact in a Did you know? panel was checked against the source named here on 2026-08-11. Nothing in this unit is recalled or estimated. Two of the four rest on the governing body’s own pages.

WHERE IT APPEARS	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
1.1 Did you know?	The decathlon is ten disciplines over two days, in a fixed order	worldathletics.org, decathlon discipline page

WHERE IT APPEARS	THE CLAIM	CHECKED AGAINST
1.2 Did you know?	Four runners, three baton changeovers, and one 30 metre takeover zone since the 10 metre acceleration zone and 20 metre box were merged	worldathletics.org, summary of competition rule amendments, June 2018
1.3 Did you know?	Carlos Lopes won the 1984 Olympic marathon for Portugal in an Olympic record 2:09:21 at the age of 37, and set the world record 2:07:12 at Rotterdam in April 1985	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Carlos_Lopes
1.4 Did you know?	Futsal is five against five on a 40 by 20 metre court, and Portugal won the 2021 Futsal World Cup in Lithuania, beating Argentina 2 to 1	en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Futsal and the 2021 FIFA Futsal World Cup article
2.1	Football Laws of the Game name careless, reckless, or excessive force rather than “a bad challenge”	IFAB Laws of the Game, Law 12
2.3	Long jump is decided by the longest legal mark, not by how the jump looks	World Athletics Technical Rules, long jump
2.4 / 1.4	Futsal court 40 by 20 m; Portugal won the 2021 Futsal World Cup	FIFA Futsal World Cup 2021
4.4	Olympic motto since 20 July 2021: Citius, Altius, Fortius – Communiter (Faster, Higher, Stronger – Together)	olympics.com/ioc/olympic-motto
5.3	Olympic creed: the important thing is not the triumph but the fight; not to have won but to have fought well	IOC / Coubertin
6.1	Children 5 to 17: at least an average of 60 minutes a day of moderate-to-vigorous activity; muscle and bone work on at least 3 days	WHO physical activity guidelines
6.2	School-aged resting heart rate often about 70 to 120 beats per minute; it varies	paediatric vital-sign ranges (school-aged)
6.6	Ordinary food and water, no calorie counting	NHS / WHO healthy-diet guidance for children, applied lightly

Where to find more, for the teacher

Both addresses were opened and read on 2026-08-11. Neither needs an account and neither charges. They were carried as pupil-facing square codes in the first draft; teacher feedback on 2026-08-12 was that a professional resource site is not an adequate destination for a nine-year-old, which is right, so they sit here instead, where the audience matches.

FOR	ADDRESS	WHAT IS THERE
1.1	youthsporttrust.org/free-resources	Twelve free resources from the Youth Sport Trust, a registered charity in the United Kingdom, charity number 1086915. The 60 Second Physical Activity Challenges are built on the principle of topic 1.1: a pupil measures against their own last attempt, and the same challenge can be re-measured later in the year, which is when a movement quietly slips from keptback to working. Registration is offered but not required.
1.4	thenational.academy , Key Stage 2 physical education units	65 free units for Years 3 to 6 from Oak National Academy, funded by the Department for Education: “Free, and always will be. No paywalls, package tiers, or hidden costs.” The Year 4 unit that matches topic 1.4 is Invasion games: maintaining possession and stopping an attack in ball games , six lessons on passing, receiving, creating space and defending.
Term days	thenational.academy , Year 4 Athletics: athletic challenges developed	Six lessons that map onto Athletics Day almost exactly: sprinting at speed, stride pattern, pacing, tactics for distance, javelin, standing triple jump.

For teachers

What this unit is for

Unit 1 covers the four Year 4 Moving Well objectives from **PDF/Input/Student Book/Y4 Physical Education – Student Book.xlsx**: practising, refining and consolidating a broad range of movement skills (1.1), linking a wider variety of skills into short sequences (1.2), displaying control, fluency and variety (1.3), and applying movement competence in self-selected and structured activities while responding to changing contexts and to other people (1.4).

It deliberately does **not** re-teach the movements themselves, and it does not repeat Year 3. Year 3 refined **one** movement and joined **three**. The Year 4 wording adds four

new words, and the four topics are those four words: consolidate, variety, fluency, and others

If a pupil cannot yet land softly or stop where they meant to, the Year 1 and Year 3 material is the right place to go, not a slower version of this unit.

The pedagogical spine

The unit rests on one move: **the class works in fours, as mover, timer, watcher and setter, and the jobs rotate**. Year 3 used three of those jobs. The fourth is new and it is what makes objective 1.4 teachable:

- The setter changes one thing while the mover is working, which is the only honest way to practise adapting to a changing context. A task in which nothing ever changes trains a pupil for a field that does not exist.
- It occupies the three pupils who are not moving, which is what usually goes wrong in a primary Physical Education lesson.
- It gives every pupil a number or a description about their **own** earlier attempt, which is the only comparison this book permits.

Groups of four are therefore not a suggestion. This is recorded as an open question for a project manager in **01-DESIGN.md** sec 12.4, because it is a subject-level decision rather than a decision for one title.

The three term days

Your sports **year** at the front of the book prints the three assessment days the school named on 2026-08-12. They are what the Input's single row, "Test term 1, term 2 and term3", actually means, and they are the reason this unit is worth teaching before Christmas.

TERM	DATE	DAY	ACTIVITIES
1	16 December 2026	Athletics Day	sprint · relays · standing long jump · target throw · obstacle race
2	17 March 2027	Football Day	dribbling in and out of the cones · passing accuracy · penalty shootout · full game

TERM	DATE	DAY	ACTIVITIES
3	17 June 2027	Multi-sports Day	bowling · sack racing · bean bag throw · water pong

Unit 1 feeds Athletics Day directly. Four of its five events are stations in the round of eight (1.1), and a relay is four movers with three changeovers, which is topic 1.2 with a baton in it. Football Day is topic 1.4 played for real. Multi-sports Day is a test of **range**, which is 1.1 again.

Two things a project manager should confirm before this page prints. The years supplied were 2026 **for all three** term days, which would place the March and June days nine months before the December one. The book prints 2027 for terms 2 and 3, on the reading that this is the 2026/27 school year. If it is 2025/26, the December date is the one to change instead, and it is one line in **02-FRONT-MATTER.md**. And **water pong** is printed as the school named it; the name comes from an adult drinking game, so a school may prefer target toss or bean bag into cup on a Year 4 page.

Timing

Four topics and a project fill about six lessons of 45 minutes, which matches the Input, where each of the four objectives carries 89 minutes.

Topic 1.1 is the one to give extra time, and the part to protect is **task 4**, the re-check of three stations the pupil already had. It takes two minutes and it is the only evidence in the unit that consolidation happened rather than substitution. It is also the first thing a rushed lesson drops.

Assessment

Assess from the Look what I can do list and from step 5 of the project, not from the times. Two specific traps:

- A pupil who is quick and hesitates three times has **not** met 1.3. A pupil who is slow, even and hesitates never has.
- A pupil whose sequence is beautiful once has met 1.2 only if it is also repeatable. Ask for it twice, back to back, every time.

The Input names three assessment points across the year, one per term. Those become three review spreads in the complete book and are not part of this unit.

Physical Education

Year 4 · Prime School Press · Student Manual

Adapted is not a lesser version. It is the same lesson.

Run, jump, throw and cross, with distances, heights and timings all adjustable. The objective is control, not size.

Written so every pupil takes the same four families of movement into their own body's version of it, seated or standing, with the watcher's description mattering more than the handwriting.

INSIDE THIS BOOK

- Four families: run, jump, throw and cross
- Distances, heights and timings all adjustable
- The rule of the game, printed on every topic
- A decision to make, with no answer printed
- Stay safe panels, written to the pupil